



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

Refund & Dispute Letter Vault

CLAIM WHAT'S RIGHTFULLY YOURS

The official process is always free. This kit doesn't sell you secrets — it's the done-for-you implementation: fill-in letters, word-for-word scripts, and trackers that save you the hours. Every method is built on official 2026 U.S. rules (DOT, IRS, CFPB, FDIC, state programs).

The Refund & Dispute Letter Vault

Every done-for-you letter and script from the entire Money You're Owed collection — 30 documents, in one place, organized by category.

This is the master vault: pull the exact letter or phone script you need, fill in the bracketed [PLACEHOLDERS], and send it. Every one cites the real 2026 rule it relies on. The official process is always free — what you're buying is the wording, done for you, so you never have to start from a blank page.

What's inside (30 editable letters & scripts)

- **Medical Bills** — 8 letters/scripts
- **Airline & Travel Refunds** — 8 letters/scripts
- **Bank & Card Fees** — 9 letters/scripts
- **Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals** — 5 letters/scripts

Tip: each section starts on its own page. Use your PDF reader's bookmarks/contents to jump straight to the category you need.

Medical Bills

Letter 1 — Itemized-Bill Request

When/how to use this: Send this the moment you receive a medical bill that shows only a lump sum, a "balance due," or vague department totals. You have the right to see every individual charge — the procedure, the supply, the medication, each with its billing code (CPT/HCPCS) and price. **Do this first, before disputing anything.** You cannot challenge a charge you can't see, and a surprising share of errors (duplicate charges, services never rendered, upcoding) only become visible on the itemized statement. Send by certified mail with return receipt, or through the provider's patient portal with a saved screenshot of the submission.

What law backs it: Billing transparency is part of standard hospital billing practice and, for nonprofit hospitals, is reinforced by the IRS Section 501(r) billing-and-collections requirements. You also need the itemized statement to exercise your insurance-appeal and No-Surprises-Act rights. There is no charge for an itemized bill — it is a routine request providers are expected to honor.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Billing Department / Patient Financial Services] [Hospital or Provider Name] [Provider Street Address] [City, State, ZIP]

Re: Request for a fully itemized bill Patient name: [Patient Full Name] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] – [MM/DD/YYYY] **Account / statement number:** [Account #] **Medical record number (if known):** [MRN]

To the Billing Department:

I am writing to request a complete, itemized statement for the account referenced above. The bill I received shows a total balance but does not break down the individual charges, so I am unable to review it for accuracy.

Please send me an itemized statement that includes, for **every** charge:

1. The date of each service or item;
2. A plain-language description of the service, supply, or medication;
3. The corresponding billing code for each line (CPT, HCPCS, and/or revenue code), and the diagnosis (ICD-10) codes used;
4. The quantity and the per-unit charge;
5. The full charge amount for each line item;

6. Any payments, adjustments, insurance write-offs, or discounts already applied; and
7. The current balance you believe I owe after those adjustments.

If any portion of this account has been submitted to my insurer, please also confirm the date it was submitted and the claim number, so I can match the bill to my Explanation of Benefits.

I am requesting this information so I can verify the charges before making payment. **Please consider any amount I might owe to be in dispute until I have received and reviewed the itemized statement.** Kindly place a hold on any collection activity, late fees, or interest on this account until you have provided the requested itemization and I have had a reasonable opportunity to review it.

Please send the itemized statement to the address above within **30 days**. If you need anything from me to process this request, contact me at the phone number or email listed above.

Thank you for your prompt attention.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures (if applicable): copy of the summary bill received; copy of insurance card (front/back).

Quick notes before you send

- **Keep the original bill.** Send copies, never your only copy.
- **Match it to your EOB.** When the itemized bill arrives, lay it next to your insurer's Explanation of Benefits. Look for charges that were never submitted to insurance, services on dates you weren't there, and duplicate line items.
- **Next step:** If the itemized bill reveals errors → **Letter 2**. If it reveals an out-of-network surprise charge → **Letter 3**. If it's correct but unaffordable → **Letter 6** (nonprofit hospital) or **Letter 7** (payment plan).

Letter 2 — Billing-Error / Overcharge Dispute

When/how to use this: Send this after you've received the itemized bill (Letter 1) and spotted specific problems — duplicate charges, services or supplies you never received, the wrong quantity, a procedure code that doesn't match what was done ("upcoding"), a charge that should have been bundled, or a price that doesn't match a good-faith estimate or quoted rate. List each disputed item precisely. Send by certified mail with return receipt, or via the portal with a saved confirmation. **Do not pay the disputed amount while it's under review.**

What law backs it: This is a direct billing dispute with the provider. For nonprofit hospitals, IRS Section 501(r) requires reasonable efforts to resolve billing before extraordinary collection actions. If insurance was involved and the "error" is actually a coverage decision, use Letter 4 (insurance appeal) instead. Disputing your own bill costs nothing and does not require a third party.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Billing Department / Patient Financial Services] [Hospital or Provider Name] [Provider Street Address] [City, State, ZIP]

Re: Dispute of specific billing errors — request for correction Patient name: [Patient Full Name] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] – [MM/DD/YYYY] **Account / statement number:** [Account #]

To the Billing Department:

I have reviewed the itemized statement for the account above against my records and my insurer's Explanation of Benefits. I dispute the following charges as incorrect and am requesting that you investigate and correct them:

#	Date	Charge / code as billed	Amount	Why it is disputed
1	[MM/DD/YYYY]	[description / CPT code]	[\$[amount]]	[e.g., "Duplicate of line 4 — same code, same date, billed twice"]
2	[MM/DD/YYYY]	[description / CPT code]	[\$[amount]]	[e.g., "Service never provided — I did not receive this medication"]
3	[MM/DD/YYYY]	[description / CPT code]	[\$[amount]]	[e.g., "Quantity billed as 3; medical record shows 1"]
4	[MM/DD/YYYY]	[description / CPT code]	[\$[amount]]	[e.g., "Code billed is a higher-level service than what was performed"]

Total amount in dispute: \$[total]

[Optional — include if relevant:] I was given a good-faith estimate / quote of **\$(quoted amount)** for this care on [date], which is attached. The billed amount exceeds that estimate without explanation, and I am asking you to reconcile the difference.

Please take the following steps:

1. **Investigate** each disputed line against the medical record and the actual services rendered;

2. **Correct or remove** any charge that is duplicated, was not provided, was billed in the wrong quantity, or was coded incorrectly;
3. **Re-bill my insurer**, if appropriate, for any charge that was not properly submitted; and
4. **Send me a corrected itemized statement** reflecting the outcome.

Until this dispute is resolved, please **place a hold on the disputed amount and on any collection activity, late fees, or interest** related to it. I am ready and willing to pay any amount that is confirmed to be accurate; I am only disputing the specific items listed above.

Please respond in writing within **30 days** to the address above. If you need records or documentation from me, contact me at the phone or email listed.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures: itemized statement (with disputed lines marked); copy of EOB; good-faith estimate or quote (if any).

Quick notes before you send

- **Be specific, not emotional.** "Line 12 duplicates line 4" wins; "this bill is outrageous" does not.
- **Mark up a copy** of the itemized bill (highlight the disputed lines, number them to match your table) and enclose it.
- **If they refuse or go silent past 30 days:** escalate to a supervisor in writing, and consider filing with your state attorney general or department of insurance/health.
- **Next step:** If the "error" turns out to be an insurance denial → **Letter 4**. If it's a true out-of-network surprise bill → **Letter 3**.

Letter 3 — Surprise / Balance-Bill Dispute (No Surprises Act)

When/how to use this: Send this when an out-of-network provider has billed you for **more than your in-network cost-sharing** in a situation the No Surprises Act protects. The classic cases: - **Emergency care** at any hospital or freestanding ER, in- or out-of-network. - **Out-of-network providers at an in-network facility** — the anesthesiologist, radiologist, pathologist, assistant surgeon, or other ancillary provider you didn't choose, during a visit to an in-network hospital or surgery center. - **Air ambulance** services.

In these cases the most you can be charged is the in-network cost-sharing amount (copay/coinsurance/deductible), and the provider may **not** "balance bill" you the difference. If you got this bill, send this letter to **both the provider and your insurer**. Send certified mail / portal with confirmation. Do not pay the balance-billed amount.

What law backs it: The **No Surprises Act** (in effect since January 1, 2022; federal regulations administered by CMS and the Departments of HHS, Labor, and Treasury). It bans balance billing for emergency services and for non-emergency services by out-of-network providers at in-network facilities, and bars providers from making you waive these protections for ancillary services. If you are **uninsured or self-pay**, the NSA also entitles you to a written **Good Faith Estimate**, and you can dispute a final bill that exceeds it by **\$400 or more** through the federal Patient-Provider Dispute Resolution process.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Billing Department, Provider Name] **AND copy to:** [Insurance Company, Appeals/Member Services] [Provider Address] [Insurer Address]

Re: Improper balance bill — No Surprises Act protections apply **Patient name:** [Patient Full Name] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] **Provider account number:** [Account #] **Insurance member ID / claim number:** [Member ID] / [Claim #] **Facility where care was provided:** [Facility Name] (in-network: [Yes/No])

To the Billing Department and to [Insurer]:

I received a bill from [Provider Name] for **[\$[balance-billed amount]]** above my in-network cost-sharing for services on [date]. I believe this is an improper balance bill that is prohibited by the **federal No Surprises Act**.

This care qualifies for No Surprises Act protection because (*check the one that applies and delete the others*):

- ☐ **It was emergency care.** I received emergency services, and the Act caps my responsibility at my plan's in-network cost-sharing regardless of whether the provider or facility was in-network.
- ☐ **It was an out-of-network provider at an in-network facility.** The facility, [Facility Name], is in my plan's network, but [Provider Name] (providing [anesthesia / radiology / pathology / assistant-surgery / other ancillary] services) was out-of-network. I did not knowingly choose this provider and did not give valid written consent to waive my balance-billing protections. For these ancillary services, such a waiver is not even permitted.
- ☐ **It was air ambulance service** furnished by an out-of-network provider.

Under the No Surprises Act, the most I can be required to pay is my **in-network cost-sharing amount** for these services. The balance-billed amount of **[\$[balance-billed amount]]** is not permitted.

I therefore request the following:

To [Provider Name]: 1. **Withdraw the balance bill** and rebill me for no more than my in-network cost-sharing; 2. **Cease any collection activity, late fees, and interest** on the disputed amount; and 3. If you believe you are entitled to additional payment, pursue it through the **federal Independent Dispute Resolution (IDR)** process with my insurer — **not** by billing me.

To [Insurer]: 1. **Process this claim under the No Surprises Act** and apply my in-network cost-sharing; and 2. Confirm in writing the correct in-network cost-sharing amount for this service.

[Use this paragraph ONLY if you are uninsured / self-pay:] I was uninsured/self-pay for this care. I was given a Good Faith Estimate of **[\$[estimate amount]]** on [date], and the final bill exceeds it by \$400 or more. I intend to use the federal **Patient-Provider Dispute Resolution** process and request that you hold collection on this account while that proceeds.

Please respond in writing within **30 days**. If you believe the No Surprises Act does not apply here, please explain specifically why, in writing.

For reference, patients can report suspected violations to the federal No Surprises Help Desk at **1-800-985-3059**.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures: copy of the bill; Explanation of Benefits; Good Faith Estimate (if uninsured); proof the facility was in-network (if applicable).

Quick notes before you send

- **Check the in-network status of the *facility*, not just the provider.** The protection for ancillary providers depends on the facility being in-network.
 - **You did NOT waive your rights** unless you signed a specific NSA consent-to-waive form *and* it was a service where waiver is allowed (it is **never** allowed for emergency care or for ancillary providers like anesthesia/radiology/pathology).
 - **Report it.** The No Surprises Help Desk (1-800-985-3059) takes complaints and is free.
 - **Next step:** If your insurer still misprocesses the claim → **Letter 4** (internal appeal), then **Letter 5** (external review).
-

Letter 4 — Internal Insurance Appeal

When/how to use this: Send this when your health insurer **denied** a claim, **paid less than expected**, said a service was **not medically necessary**, called it **experimental/investigational**, or denied for a **coverage or network** reason. This is your **internal appeal** — the first formal step, handled inside the insurance company. You generally have **at least 180 days from the date on the denial notice (the EOB or denial letter)** to file. Send by certified mail and/or the insurer's portal; keep proof of the date. If the situation is urgent (delay would seriously jeopardize health), say so and request an **expedited** review.

What law backs it: The **Affordable Care Act (ACA)** and, for employer plans, **ERISA**, guarantee a full and fair internal appeal. ACA-compliant plans must give you **at least 180 days** to file an internal appeal, and must decide within set windows: generally **30 days** for services not yet received (pre-service), **60 days** for services already received (post-service), and **72 hours** for urgent/expedited cases. You also have the right to request, **free of charge**, the documents and criteria the insurer used to make its decision.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Insurance Company Name] [Appeals Department] [Insurer Address]

Re: Internal appeal of claim denial / underpayment **Member name:** [Patient Full Name]
Member ID: [Member ID #] **Group number:** [Group #] **Claim number(s):** [Claim #] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] **Date of denial notice being appealed:** [MM/DD/YYYY]

To the Appeals Department:

I am formally appealing your decision to [deny / underpay] the claim referenced above. Please treat this as a request for a full internal appeal under my plan and applicable federal law (ACA/ERISA).

The reason you gave for the denial was: [quote the exact reason from the EOB / denial letter, e.g., "not medically necessary," "out-of-network," "service not covered," "needed prior authorization," "experimental/investigational"].

I am appealing because: *(use the points that apply; be specific and factual)*

- The service was **medically necessary**. [Brief explanation. Reference enclosed letter of medical necessity / records from Dr. [Name].]
- The denial appears to be a **coding or processing error**. [Explain — e.g., the claim was filed under the wrong code, or a prior authorization on file (auth # []) was not applied.]
- This care is **covered under my plan**. [Cite the plan provision / Summary of Benefits language if you have it.]

- *[If applicable]* No Surprises Act protections apply to this service, so my cost-sharing should be at the in-network level. [See enclosed.]
- *[If applicable]* The denial conflicts with the treating physician's recommendation, which is enclosed.

I request that you: 1. **Overturn the denial** and process/pay the claim; 2. Provide me, **free of charge**, with copies of all documents, records, internal guidelines, and medical-necessity criteria used to make this decision, and the name and credentials of the reviewer; and 3. Confirm your decision in writing, including my further appeal rights.

[Include this paragraph ONLY for urgent cases:] **This is a request for an EXPEDITED appeal.** Waiting the standard timeframe would seriously jeopardize the patient's health or ability to regain maximum function. Please decide within **72 hours** and contact me immediately at [phone].

Per federal law, please render your internal-appeal decision within the required timeframe — generally **30 days** for pre-service claims and **60 days** for post-service claims. If you uphold the denial, please provide a written explanation and confirm my right to request an **external independent review**.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures: copy of EOB / denial letter; letter of medical necessity from treating physician; relevant medical records; copy of prior authorization (if any); any supporting clinical literature.

Quick notes before you send

- **The strongest appeals come from the doctor.** Ask your physician's office for a **letter of medical necessity** — it dramatically raises your odds.
- **Quote their exact denial reason** and rebut *that* reason. Don't argue a point they didn't make.
- **File on time.** Use the date on the denial notice and count your 180 days. File early.
- **Save everything** — the date you mailed/submitted, the claim numbers, every reference number a rep gives you.
- **Next step:** If the internal appeal is denied → **Letter 5** (external review). You generally have **4 months** from the final internal denial.

Letter 5 — External Independent Review Request

When/how to use this: Send this **after your internal appeal (Letter 4) has been denied** — when the insurer upheld its decision and gave you a "final internal adverse determination."

External review hands your case to an **independent third party** (an Independent Review Organization) that is **not** the insurer. Its decision is **binding** on the insurer. You generally have **4 months (120 days) from the date of the final internal denial** to request it. Send to the address/instructions on your final denial letter; if none, your state's department of insurance or the federal external-review process (often run by an HHS-contracted administrator) can route it. For urgent cases you can request an **expedited external review** — sometimes simultaneously with the internal appeal.

What law backs it: The **Affordable Care Act** guarantees external review for most plans. Decisions on denials based on **medical necessity, appropriateness, or experimental/investigational** status are sent to an Independent Review Organization. Standard external decisions are due within **45 days**; **expedited** decisions within **72 hours**. The reviewer's decision binds the insurer. Independent reviewers overturn a meaningful share of denials, so this step is worth taking.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[External Review Administrator / Insurer External-Review Unit / State DOI] (*use the contact named on your final internal-denial letter*) [Address]

Re: Request for external independent review **Member name:** [Patient Full Name] **Member ID:** [Member ID #] **Plan / insurer:** [Insurance Company Name] **Claim number(s):** [Claim #] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] **Date of FINAL internal denial:** [MM/DD/YYYY]

To the External Review Administrator:

I am requesting an **external independent review** of the final adverse determination issued by [Insurance Company Name] on [date]. I have completed the insurer's internal appeal process, and the denial was upheld. I am submitting this request within the **four-month** window.

Service/treatment at issue: [describe — e.g., "MRI of lumbar spine," "30-day inpatient rehabilitation," "[drug name]"]

The insurer's final reason for denial was: [quote exactly — e.g., "not medically necessary," "experimental/investigational"].

I am requesting external review because I believe the denial is wrong for the following reasons: (*use what applies*) - The treating physician has determined this care is medically necessary [see enclosed letter of medical necessity]; - The service is the recognized standard of care for my condition [see enclosed clinical documentation]; - The "experimental/investigational" label is incorrect because [explanation / cite guideline or FDA approval]; - The insurer did not adequately consider the records I provided in the internal appeal.

I am enclosing the following for the independent reviewer: 1. The insurer's final internal-denial letter; 2. The original Explanation of Benefits / denial; 3. My internal appeal letter and all supporting documents I previously submitted; 4. A letter of medical necessity from my treating physician, Dr. [Name]; 5. Relevant medical records and any supporting clinical literature.

I authorize the release of my relevant medical records to the Independent Review Organization for the purpose of this review.

[Include ONLY for urgent cases:] **This is a request for an EXPEDITED external review.** A delay would seriously jeopardize the patient's life, health, or ability to regain maximum function. Please decide within **72 hours** and contact me immediately at [phone].

Please confirm receipt and provide the assigned reviewer and expected decision date. I understand the standard decision is due within **45 days** and that the decision will be **binding** on the insurer.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures: final internal-denial letter; original EOB/denial; prior internal appeal packet; physician letter of medical necessity; medical records; clinical literature; signed records-release authorization.

Quick notes before you send

- **Read your final denial letter for the exact route.** It must tell you how to request external review and the deadline. Some states run their own process; others use the federal HHS-administered process. Follow whichever your letter names.
- **Resend your best evidence.** The external reviewer reads what you give them — include the physician letter and records again, even if the insurer already had them.
- **It's free** to you. Insurers fund the external-review process; you don't pay the reviewer.
- **Binding decision.** If the IRO sides with you, the insurer must cover the service. If it doesn't, ask about further options (state regulator complaint, or legal advice for ERISA plans).
- **Next step:** If you still owe a balance the insurer won't cover and the bill is unaffordable → **Letter 6** (nonprofit charity care) or **Letter 7** (payment plan/settlement).

Letter 6 — Hospital Financial-Assistance / Charity-Care Request (501(r))

When/how to use this: Send this when a hospital bill is unaffordable and the hospital is a **nonprofit (501(c)(3))** — which includes most U.S. hospitals, including many large systems and most religious and university hospitals. Nonprofit hospitals are **required by federal law** to have a written Financial Assistance Policy (FAP) that can reduce or **eliminate** your bill based on income. This letter requests the FAP and the application, and asks them to **pause collections** while you apply. Send early — ideally as soon as you get a bill you can't afford — but you generally have a long window (commonly **240 days from your first bill**) to apply. Certified mail / portal with confirmation.

What law backs it: IRS Section 501(r), which all 501(c)(3) hospitals must follow to keep their tax-exempt status. It requires them to (1) maintain and widely publicize a written **Financial Assistance Policy**; (2) limit charges to FAP-eligible patients to no more than the **Amounts Generally Billed (AGB)** — i.e., roughly what insured patients pay, not inflated "chargemaster" rates; and (3) make **reasonable efforts to determine FAP eligibility before extraordinary collection actions** (like sending you to collections, suing, or reporting to credit bureaus). Many hospitals must accept applications for **at least 240 days** from the first post-discharge bill. Applying for charity care is always free.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Hospital Name] [Financial Assistance / Patient Financial Services Department] [Hospital Address]

Re: Request for financial assistance under your Financial Assistance Policy (IRS §501(r))
Patient name: [Patient Full Name] **Date(s) of service:** [MM/DD/YYYY] **Account / statement number:** [Account #] **Total balance billed:** \$[amount]

To the Financial Assistance Department:

I am requesting financial assistance for the account above. I understand that, as a nonprofit hospital, [Hospital Name] maintains a written **Financial Assistance Policy (FAP)** under IRS Section 501(r), and I would like to apply.

Please send me, as soon as possible: 1. A **plain-language summary of your Financial Assistance Policy** and the **full FAP**; 2. The **financial assistance application form** and a list of the documents required to apply; 3. Your **FAP-eligibility income criteria** (e.g., the Federal Poverty Level percentages you use for free vs. discounted care); and 4. An explanation of the **Amounts Generally Billed (AGB)** for the services on my account, since under §501(r) I cannot be charged more than the AGB if I am FAP-eligible.

My situation: [Briefly describe — e.g., household size, income, recent job loss, other large medical bills, that the balance exceeds what you can reasonably pay. Keep it factual.]

I request that, while my application is pending, you: - **Hold all collection activity**, including sending this account to a collection agency, reporting it to credit bureaus, charging interest or late fees, or any extraordinary collection action; and - **Confirm in writing the deadline by which I must submit my completed application** (I understand this is commonly at least **240 days from my first bill**).

If I have already paid any amount on this account that exceeds what I would owe as a FAP-eligible patient, I request a **refund of the difference**, consistent with your policy.

Please send the policy and application to the address above and confirm receipt of this request. If you need additional information from me to begin the eligibility determination, contact me at [phone] or [email].

Thank you for your help.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Enclosures (if ready): proof of income (recent pay stubs / benefit letter / prior-year tax return); proof of household size; documentation of hardship.

Quick notes before you send

- **Confirm the hospital is nonprofit.** Search the hospital name + "Financial Assistance Policy" or "501(r)" — almost every nonprofit posts it. If it's a for-profit hospital, 501(r) doesn't apply, but most still have a charity/discount program — ask anyway and use **Letter 7** to negotiate.
- **You can qualify even with insurance.** FAP eligibility is about income and the size of the bill, not whether you're insured.
- **Apply even if it's already in collections.** The 240-day window and the "reasonable efforts" rule can require them to pull it back and review you.
- **Watch the AGB cap.** If they bill you full "sticker" charges after you qualify, point to §501(r)(5) — they can't charge FAP-eligible patients more than AGB.
- **Next step:** If you don't qualify for full charity care but still can't pay in a lump sum → **Letter 7** (settlement / payment plan).

Letter 7 — Settlement & Payment-Plan Offer

When/how to use this: Send this when the charge is **confirmed correct** (you've already done Letters 1–2 and any insurance appeal), but you **can't pay it in full**. You have two plays here, and the letter covers both: (A) offer a **lump-sum settlement** for less than the full balance in

exchange for marking the account paid-in-full, or (B) request an **interest-free monthly payment plan** you can actually afford. Hospitals and collectors routinely accept both, because partial payment now beats chasing you later. **Get any agreement in writing before you pay a cent.** Send certified mail / portal with confirmation.

What law backs it: This is a negotiation, not a statutory right, so there's no single law to cite — and that's fine. Use it *after* you've exhausted the rights-based letters. One protection to know: if a **debt collector** (not the original hospital) holds the account, the **Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA)** governs how they may contact you, and you can request **written validation of the debt**. If the hospital is nonprofit, prefer **Letter 6** first — charity care can wipe out far more than a settlement.

[Your Full Name] [Your Street Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Your Phone] · [Your Email] [Date]

[Hospital / Provider / Collection Agency Name] [Billing or Account-Resolution Department]
[Address]

Re: Offer to resolve account — [settlement / payment plan] Patient name: [Patient Full Name] **Account / reference number:** [Account #] **Current balance:** \$[balance]

To the Billing / Account-Resolution Department:

I want to resolve the account above. I have confirmed the charges are correct, and I am committed to paying what I genuinely can. I cannot pay the full balance in a lump sum, so I am making the following good-faith offer.

Choose and keep ONE of the two options below; delete the other.

OPTION A — Lump-sum settlement

I am prepared to pay **\$[offer amount]** (approximately []% of the balance) as **payment in full** to settle and close this account. This is the most I am able to pay at one time. In exchange, I ask that you agree in writing to: 1. Accept **\$[offer amount]** as **full and final satisfaction** of the account; 2. **Not pursue** the remaining balance, sell it, or refer it to collections; and 3. Report the account as **"paid in full" / "settled, \$0 balance,"** and, if it has been reported to any credit bureau, request its **deletion or update to reflect a zero balance**.

Upon receiving your written agreement to these terms, I will send payment within [10] business days by [method].

OPTION B — Interest-free monthly payment plan

I can reliably pay **\$[monthly amount] per month** until the balance is satisfied. I request a **payment plan with no interest and no fees**, and ask that you agree in writing to: 1. Accept monthly payments of \$[monthly amount] beginning [date]; 2. **Charge no interest, late fees, or penalties** while I make agreed payments on time; 3. **Not refer the account to collections or report it adversely** to credit bureaus while the plan is in good standing; and 4. Send me a written confirmation of these terms and a simple receipt or running balance.

For both options: *[If a collection agency holds this debt, include:]* Please also provide **written validation of this debt** (the amount, the original creditor, and that it is mine) before I make any payment, as is my right under the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act.

Please respond in writing within **30 days**. I am acting in good faith and want to close this out fairly; I just need terms I can actually meet. Do not consider any payment I make to be an admission regarding any portion of the bill I have previously disputed.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name]

Quick notes before you send

- **Get it in writing FIRST.** Never pay on a verbal promise. A "paid in full" agreement is worthless if it's not on paper before your money moves.
 - **Start your settlement offer low** (e.g., 25–40% of the balance) — you can come up; you can't come down.
 - **Try charity care first** at nonprofit hospitals (**Letter 6**). A settlement at 40% is a worse deal than a charity-care write-off at 100%.
 - **Don't let a payment "reset the clock."** On old debts, making a payment can sometimes restart the statute of limitations in some states — ask before paying on an old account.
 - **Match the plan to reality.** Offer a monthly amount you can sustain for the full term. A blown payment plan is worse than a smaller one you keep.
-

Letter 8 — Medical-Debt Credit-Reporting Dispute

When/how to use this: Send this when a medical debt is showing up on your credit report and it shouldn't be — because it's **wrong, not yours, already paid, under \$500, less than a year old, or you never owed it** (for example, it was actually a No Surprises Act violation or your insurer should have paid it). You send this to the **credit bureaus** (Equifax, Experian, TransUnion) that are reporting the item, and you can also send a copy to the **collector or hospital** that furnished it. Send certified mail with return receipt, or use each bureau's online

dispute portal and save the confirmation. Dispute with **every** bureau that shows the item — they're separate companies.

What law backs it: Two things, and it's important to understand the difference:

1. **The Fair Credit Reporting Act (FCRA), 15 U.S.C. §1681i and §1681s-2.** This is your permanent, federal right to dispute *anything inaccurate or unverifiable* on your credit report. Once you dispute, the bureau must investigate — generally **within 30 days** (up to 45 in some cases) — and **delete** any item it cannot verify. The furnisher (the hospital or collector) must investigate too and correct or remove what's wrong. These rights apply to all debts, medical or not.
2. **The voluntary credit-bureau medical-debt policy** (Equifax, Experian, and TransUnion, phased in 2022–2023, still in effect in 2026). Under it: **paid medical collections are removed**; medical collections are **not reported until at least one year (365 days)** after they go to collections; and medical collections with an original balance **under \$500 are not reported at all**. If a medical item violates one of these policies, you can dispute it on that basis.

The reality check that keeps this kit honest: You may have read that "medical debt is being removed from all credit reports." In **January 2025** the CFPB finalized a rule that would have done exactly that. **A federal court vacated that rule on July 11, 2025 (Cornerstone Credit Union League v. CFPB, E.D. Tex.), and it is NOT in force in 2026.** So a medical collection of \$500 or more that's over a year old **can still legally appear on your credit report** federally. Don't dispute it by citing the CFPB rule — that argument will fail. Dispute it on the grounds that actually work: it's inaccurate, it's paid, it's under \$500, it's too new, or your state bans it (several states do — check yours). This letter is built around the grounds that work.

[Your Full Name] [Your Mailing Address] [City, State, ZIP] [Date of Birth] · [Last 4 of SSN]

[Date]

[Credit Bureau Name — send a separate copy to each that reports the item] Equifax: P.O. Box 740256, Atlanta, GA 30374 Experian: P.O. Box 4500, Allen, TX 75013 TransUnion: P.O. Box 2000, Chester, PA 19016

Re: Dispute of inaccurate medical collection — request for investigation and deletion

Reported item: [Collector/Furnisher Name], account/reference number [Account #] **Amount shown:** \$[Amount] **Date reported / date of first delinquency:** [Date shown on report]

To Whom It May Concern:

I am disputing the medical collection account identified above, which appears on my credit report. Under the **Fair Credit Reporting Act, 15 U.S.C. §1681i**, I request that you conduct a reasonable investigation of this item and **delete it** if it cannot be verified as accurate and reportable.

This item is inaccurate or improperly reported for the following reason(s) (*check all that apply and delete the rest*):

- ☐ **It is not mine / I do not recognize this debt.** I have no record of owing this amount to this provider or collector.
- ☐ **It is already paid.** This medical collection has been paid in full as of [date]. Under the credit bureaus' own medical-debt reporting policy, **paid medical collections are not reported.** Proof of payment is enclosed.
- ☐ **The original balance is under \$500.** The original amount of this medical collection was **less than \$500**, which under the credit bureaus' medical-debt reporting policy is **not reported at all.**
- ☐ **It is less than one year old.** This medical debt was placed in collections on [date], which is **less than 365 days ago.** Under the bureaus' policy, medical collections are not reported until at least one year after they go to collections.
- ☐ **The amount is wrong.** The correct balance is \$[correct amount], not \$[amount shown]. (*Attach the corrected/itemized bill.*)
- ☐ **I never owed this — it should have been covered.** This charge was an improper bill (for example, a balance bill prohibited by the No Surprises Act, or a service my insurer was required to pay). It was sent to collections in error. (*Attach supporting documents — EOB, insurer letter, etc.*)
- ☐ **It is being disputed with the provider.** I have an open billing dispute or insurance appeal on this charge, and it should not have been sent to collections or reported while unresolved.

I request that you:

1. Conduct a reasonable investigation of this item as required by **15 U.S.C. §1681i**;
2. Forward this dispute and all enclosed documents to the furnisher;
3. **Delete the item** if it cannot be verified as accurate and reportable; and
4. Send me the written results of your investigation and, if any change is made, a free updated copy of my credit report.

I am enclosing copies (not originals) of supporting documents. Please complete your investigation within the **30 days** required by the FCRA.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature] [Your Printed Name] [Date]

Enclosures: copy of the credit report with the item circled; proof of payment (if paid); itemized bill (if amount is wrong); EOB / insurer correspondence (if it should have been covered); copy of a government-issued ID and a utility bill (bureaus often require these to verify identity).

After you send

- **The bureau has ~30 days** (up to 45 if you send more information mid-investigation) to respond. If they verify it and you still believe it's wrong, you can: (a) add a **100-word statement of dispute** to your file, (b) file a complaint with the **CFPB** (consumerfinance.gov/complaint) or your state attorney general, or (c) consult an attorney — FCRA violations can entitle you to damages.
- **Also dispute with the furnisher.** Sending a copy to the collector or hospital triggers their duties under **§1681s-2**.
- **If the underlying bill is the real problem**, fix that first or alongside this: an itemized-bill request (Letter 1), an error dispute (Letter 2), a No Surprises Act dispute (Letter 3), or charity care (Letter 6) can make the debt itself disappear, which is the cleanest way to get it off your credit.
- **Check your state law.** Several states (including CA, CO, CT, IL, MD, MN, NJ, NY, RI, VA, others) restrict or ban medical-debt credit reporting beyond the federal floor. If you live in one, say so in your dispute and cite the state law.

Airline & Travel Refunds

01 — Cancellation / Significant-Change Refund Letter

When/how to use this

Use this when the **airline canceled your flight**, or made a **significant change** to it, and you did **not** fly — either because you rejected the rebooking they offered, or they never got you where you were going. This is the letter that demands your money back to your **original form of payment**, not a voucher or travel credit.

A "significant change" includes: - Departure time moved **more than 3 hours earlier** (domestic) or **more than 6 hours** (international) - Arrival time moved **more than 3 hours later** (domestic) or **more than 6 hours** (international) - A **change in departure or arrival airport** - An **added connection / extra stop** - A **downgrade** to a lower class of service - A switch to a **less accessible** aircraft (for passengers with disabilities)

Send it by the airline's official complaint/refund web form **and** email so you have a timestamped paper trail. Then log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09).

What law backs it

DOT Automatic Refund Rule — 14 CFR Part 260 (compliance date October 28, 2024). When a U.S. or foreign air carrier cancels or significantly changes a flight to, from, or within the U.S. and the passenger does not accept rebooking or other compensation, the airline must issue an **automatic refund** of the unused ticket and any extra fees, **to the original form of payment (cash-equivalent), not a voucher**. Refunds are due within **7 business days** for credit-card purchases and **20 calendar days** for other payment forms. Refunds must include all government-imposed taxes and airline fees, minus the value of any travel actually used.

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Refunds / Customer Relations **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE OFFICIAL REFUND FORM URL] and [REFUND/CUSTOMER-RELATIONS EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name: [YOUR FULL NAME, exactly as on the ticket] **Confirmation / record locator:** [6-CHARACTER CODE] **Ticket number(s):** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER(S)]
Frequent-flyer #: [IF ANY]

Flight affected: - Route: [ORIGIN AIRPORT] → [DESTINATION AIRPORT] - Flight number: [FLIGHT NUMBER] - Original scheduled date/time: [DATE] at [TIME] - What happened: [☐ flight was canceled / ☐ flight was significantly changed] - Details of the change: [e.g., "departure moved from 8:00 AM to 1:30 PM, a 5.5-hour delay" OR "the only rebooking offered arrived the next day"]

To whom it may concern,

My flight identified above was [canceled / significantly changed] by [AIRLINE NAME]. I was either not offered acceptable alternative transportation or I declined the alternative offered, and I did not accept a travel credit, voucher, or other compensation in place of a refund.

Under the U.S. Department of Transportation's Automatic Refund Rule (**14 CFR Part 260**), when an airline cancels or significantly changes a flight to, from, or within the United States and the passenger does not accept rebooking, a travel credit, or a voucher, the airline is required to issue a prompt, **automatic refund to the original form of payment** for the unused portion of the ticket, including all government-imposed taxes and fees and all airline-imposed fees. I am requesting that refund now.

I paid [**\$ AMOUNT**] by [**ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT — e.g., Visa ending 4321 / debit card / PayPal / airline miles**] on [**PURCHASE DATE**]. I am requesting a **full refund to that original form of payment**. I am **not** requesting and will **not** accept a travel voucher or credit in place of this cash-equivalent refund.

The rule requires this refund to be issued promptly — within **7 business days** if I paid by credit card, or within **20 calendar days** for any other form of payment. Please confirm in writing that the refund has been processed and provide the refund reference number.

If I do not receive a confirmation and refund within the timeframe above, I will file a complaint with the U.S. Department of Transportation Office of Aviation Consumer Protection.

Thank you for your prompt attention.

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

After you send it

- **Save** the confirmation page / auto-reply email.
- **Set a deadline** in the Claim Tracker: 7 business days (credit card) or 20 calendar days (other).
- **If they offer a voucher**, reply in writing: *"I decline the voucher and am requesting a refund to my original form of payment as required under 14 CFR Part 260."*
- **If they miss the deadline or refuse**, escalate with Asset 06 (DOT complaint).

02 — Significant-Delay / Schedule-Change Refund Letter

When/how to use this

Use this when the airline **delayed or rescheduled** your flight by enough that you **chose not to travel** and want your money back. The trigger is the same "significant change" standard as a cancellation: a shift of **more than 3 hours** (domestic) or **more than 6 hours** (international) in departure or arrival time, an airport change, an added stop, or a downgrade.

Important distinction: U.S. law does **not** pay you a fixed cash penalty just because a flight was late (that's an EU261 thing — see Asset 08). What U.S. law *does* require is a **full refund of your fare** if the change is "significant" and you decide not to fly. So this letter is for travelers who said *"that delay/reschedule no longer works for me — give me my money back,"* not for travelers who flew anyway and want a delay bonus.

If you **already flew** despite the delay, you are generally not owed a U.S. refund — but check Asset 04 if you also paid for a service you didn't receive, and Asset 08 if the flight touched the EU.

What law backs it

DOT Automatic Refund Rule — 14 CFR Part 260. A "significant change of flight itinerary" includes a departure time advanced, or an arrival time delayed, by **more than 3 hours for a domestic flight** or **more than 6 hours for an international flight**, a change of origin/destination airport, an added connection, a downgrade, or a change to a less accessible aircraft. If the passenger does not accept rebooking, a voucher, or a credit, the airline must issue an **automatic refund to the original form of payment (cash-equivalent)** within **7 business days** (credit card) or **20 calendar days** (other), including taxes and fees.

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Refunds / Customer Relations **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE OFFICIAL REFUND FORM URL] and [REFUND/CUSTOMER-RELATIONS EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name: [YOUR FULL NAME, exactly as on the ticket] **Confirmation / record locator:** [6-CHARACTER CODE] **Ticket number(s):** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER(S)]

Flight affected: - Route: [ORIGIN] → [DESTINATION] (this is a [☐ domestic / ☐ international] flight) - Flight number: [FLIGHT NUMBER] - Originally scheduled: depart [DATE/TIME], arrive

[DATE/TIME] - Revised by the airline to: depart [NEW DATE/TIME], arrive [NEW DATE/TIME] -
Size of the change: [e.g., "arrival moved 4 hours 20 minutes later"]

To whom it may concern,

[AIRLINE NAME] made a significant change to the flight identified above. The [departure / arrival] time was moved by **[X hours Y minutes]**, which exceeds the threshold for a "significant change of flight itinerary" under DOT rules — **more than 3 hours for a domestic flight, or more than 6 hours for an international flight** [delete whichever does not apply]. [If applicable: The change also involved [an airport change / an added connection / a downgrade].]

This change did not work for my travel plans. I did **not** accept the revised itinerary, and I did **not** accept a travel credit, voucher, or other compensation.

Under the U.S. Department of Transportation's Automatic Refund Rule (**14 CFR Part 260**), when an airline significantly changes a flight to, from, or within the United States and the passenger declines the alternative, the airline must issue a prompt, **automatic refund to the original form of payment**, including all taxes and fees. I am requesting that refund now.

I paid **[\$ AMOUNT]** by **[ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT]** on **[PURCHASE DATE]**. Please refund the full amount to that original form of payment. I am **not** requesting a voucher or travel credit.

Please process this refund within the required timeframe — **7 business days** (credit card) or **20 calendar days** (other payment) — and confirm in writing with a refund reference number.

If the refund is not issued within that window, I will file a complaint with the U.S. DOT Office of Aviation Consumer Protection.

Sincerely,

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

After you send it

- Screenshot the **original** schedule and the **revised** schedule (the email or app notification proving the size of the change). That timestamped proof is your whole case.
- Log the deadline in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09).
- If they push a voucher, decline in writing and cite 14 CFR Part 260.
- No response or a refusal → Asset 06 (DOT complaint).

03 — Checked-Bag Delay Fee Refund Letter

When/how to use this

Use this when you **paid a checked-bag fee** and the airline delivered your bag **late** — past the legal cutoff. You're owed your **bag fee back**. (This is separate from any claim for the *value* of delayed/lost contents; see the note at the bottom.)

The cutoffs that trigger your bag-fee refund: - **Domestic flight:** bag not delivered within **12 hours** of the flight arriving at the gate. - **International flight 12 hours or shorter:** bag not delivered within **15 hours** of arrival. - **International flight longer than 12 hours:** bag not delivered within **30 hours** of arrival.

Required first step: You must **file a mishandled-baggage report** with the airline (at the airport baggage office, or online/phone right after). The refund right is tied to that report. Get the file/reference number — you'll need it below.

What law backs it

DOT Automatic Refund Rule — 14 CFR Part 260. Airlines must refund the checked-bag fee when a bag is "**significantly delayed**" — defined as not delivered within **12 hours (domestic)**, **15 hours (international flights of 12 hours or less)**, or **30 hours (international flights over 12 hours)** after arrival — provided the passenger filed a mishandled-baggage report. (Separately, the domestic baggage **liability limit** under **14 CFR Part 254** is **\$4,700** per passenger for the actual value of lost/damaged/delayed baggage, effective January 22, 2025.)

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Baggage Service / Customer Relations **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE OFFICIAL BAGGAGE-CLAIM / REFUND FORM URL] and [EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name: [YOUR FULL NAME] **Confirmation / record locator:** [6-CHARACTER CODE] **Ticket number:** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER] **Mishandled-baggage / file reference number:** [PIR / FILE REFERENCE FROM YOUR REPORT]

Flight & bag details: - Route: [ORIGIN] → [DESTINATION] (this was a [☐ domestic / ☐ international] flight; flight duration [HOURS]) - Flight number: [FLIGHT NUMBER] - Arrival at gate: [DATE] at [TIME] - Bag actually delivered: [DATE] at [TIME] → delay of [**X hours**] - Checked-bag fee paid: [**\$ AMOUNT**] on [**ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT**]

To whom it may concern,

I am requesting a refund of the **checked-bag fee** I paid on the flight above. My checked bag was significantly delayed: it arrived [**X hours**] after my flight reached the gate, which exceeds the DOT threshold for a significantly delayed bag — **12 hours for a domestic flight, 15 hours for**

an international flight of 12 hours or less, or 30 hours for an international flight longer than 12 hours [keep the one that applies].

I filed a mishandled-baggage report at/after arrival; the reference number is **[FILE REFERENCE]**.

Under the U.S. Department of Transportation's Automatic Refund Rule (**14 CFR Part 260**), the checked-bag fee for a significantly delayed bag must be **refunded to the original form of payment**. I paid **[\$ AMOUNT]** by **[ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT]**. Please refund that amount to my original form of payment and confirm in writing with a refund reference number.

[Optional — only if you also had out-of-pocket losses: In addition to the bag-fee refund, my delayed bag caused documented expenses of **[\$ AMOUNT]** for [necessary replacement items]. Receipts are attached. I am submitting these for reimbursement under the carrier's baggage-liability obligations (domestic limit \$4,700 per passenger under 14 CFR Part 254).]

If the bag-fee refund is not processed promptly, I will file a complaint with the U.S. DOT Office of Aviation Consumer Protection.

Sincerely,

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

Attachments: [bag-fee receipt], [mishandled-baggage report], [delivery confirmation showing date/time], [receipts for replacement items, if claiming].

After you send it

- The **bag-fee refund** and the **value-of-contents claim** are two different things. The bag fee is owed automatically once the delay crosses the cutoff and you filed a report. The contents/expenses claim is a separate negotiation capped at **\$4,700** (domestic) and requires receipts.
- Keep the delivery confirmation that shows the **exact delivery time** — that's what proves you crossed the cutoff.
- Log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09). No response → Asset 06 (DOT complaint).

04 — Ancillary-Fee Refund Letter (paid service not provided)

When/how to use this

Use this when you **paid extra for a service the airline did not provide**. Common examples: - **Wi-Fi** you bought but that didn't work the whole flight - A **paid seat assignment** (extra legroom, preferred seat) you were moved out of - **Priority / early boarding** you paid for but weren't given - **Lounge access**, in-flight **entertainment**, or a **meal** you prepaid and didn't receive - A **seat upgrade** you paid for, then got downgraded

If the airline didn't deliver the thing you paid for, that fee is refundable to your original form of payment. This is one of the clearest, fastest wins in the toolkit.

What law backs it

DOT Automatic Refund Rule — 14 CFR Part 260. Airlines must **automatically refund fees paid for ancillary services** (such as Wi-Fi, seat selection, or in-flight entertainment) **when the airline fails to provide the service**. The refund must go to the **original form of payment (cash-equivalent), not a voucher**, and must be issued promptly — **7 business days** (credit card) or **20 calendar days** (other payment).

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Customer Relations / Refunds **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE OFFICIAL REFUND FORM URL] and [EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name: [YOUR FULL NAME] **Confirmation / record locator:** [6-CHARACTER CODE] **Ticket number:** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER]

Service not provided: - Flight: [FLIGHT NUMBER], [ORIGIN] → [DESTINATION], [DATE] - Service I paid for: [e.g., "in-flight Wi-Fi day pass" / "Economy Plus seat 12C" / "Priority boarding"] - Amount paid: **[\$ AMOUNT]** on **[ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT]**, purchased **[DATE]** - What happened: [e.g., "Wi-Fi never connected for the entire 3-hour flight" / "I was reassigned from my paid extra-legroom seat to a standard middle seat" / "priority boarding was not offered and I boarded with the general group"]

To whom it may concern,

I paid **[\$ AMOUNT]** for **[SERVICE]** on the flight above, and the airline **did not provide** that service. [One sentence of specifics, e.g., "The Wi-Fi I purchased failed to connect for the entire flight," or "I was moved out of the extra-legroom seat I paid for and placed in a standard economy seat."]

Under the U.S. Department of Transportation's Automatic Refund Rule (**14 CFR Part 260**), when an airline fails to provide a paid ancillary service, it must issue a **refund of that fee to the**

original form of payment. I am requesting a full refund of **[\$ AMOUNT]** to **[ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT]**. I am **not** requesting a voucher, travel credit, or miles in place of this refund.

Please process the refund promptly — within **7 business days** (credit card) or **20 calendar days** (other payment) — and confirm in writing with a refund reference number.

If the refund is not issued, I will file a complaint with the U.S. DOT Office of Aviation Consumer Protection.

Sincerely,

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

Attachments: [receipt for the paid service], [boarding pass / seat map showing what you paid for], [any photo or note documenting the failure, e.g., a screenshot of the Wi-Fi error].

After you send it

- Document the failure **in the moment** when you can: a photo of the dead Wi-Fi portal, a note of the flight attendant's name who resealed you, a screenshot of your original paid seat. This is what turns a "he said / she said" into an easy approval.
 - Log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09). No response → Asset 06 (DOT complaint).
 - If your bank shows the charge, a credit-card dispute is a fallback — but try the airline refund first; it's faster and keeps your record clean.
-

05 — Airline Phone / Chat Customer-Service Script

When/how to use this

Use this when you'd rather **call or live-chat** the airline than send a letter — or when a letter went unanswered and you want to push verbally. Read it almost word-for-word. The goal is to stay calm, name the exact rule, and get a **written confirmation and a refund reference number** before you hang up.

Two rules for any call/chat: 1. **Get names and numbers.** Write down the agent's name, the time, and any case/reference number. In chat, **save the transcript**. 2. **Never accept a voucher by accident.** If they offer a travel credit, you must explicitly say you want a refund to your original form of payment, or they may log it as "resolved with a voucher."

What law backs it

Same as the letters: **DOT Automatic Refund Rule (14 CFR Part 260)** for refunds; **14 CFR Part 250** for denied-boarding compensation. You're not arguing — you're citing the rule and asking

them to apply it.

SCRIPT — opening (use for any refund situation)

"Hi, my name is **[YOUR NAME]**. My confirmation code is **[CODE]**. I'm calling about **[flight number, date, route]**. The airline **[canceled / significantly changed / delayed]** this flight **[or: didn't provide the Wi-Fi/seat/service I paid for / delivered my checked bag late]**, and under the DOT Automatic Refund Rule — **14 CFR Part 260** — I'm requesting a **refund to my original form of payment**, not a voucher. Can you process that for me today?"

Then **stop talking** and let them respond.

If they offer a voucher or travel credit

"I appreciate that, but I'm not requesting a voucher or travel credit. Under 14 CFR Part 260, I'm entitled to a refund to my **original form of payment** — the **[card / payment method]** I used. Please log this as a **refund request to original form of payment**, not a credit."

If they insist a voucher is "all they can do":

"I understand that may be the default offer, but the DOT rule requires a cash-equivalent refund to my original payment method when I decline the alternative. I'm declining the voucher. Please escalate this to someone who can process a refund, or note on my file that I requested one and was refused, with the date and your name."

If they say the change "wasn't significant"

"My **[departure / arrival]** time moved by **[X hours]**. For a **[domestic / international]** flight a significant change is anything more than **[3 hours / 6 hours]**, and mine is past that, so this qualifies. I'm requesting the refund under 14 CFR Part 260."

For a delayed checked bag

"I filed a mishandled-baggage report, reference **[NUMBER]**. My bag arrived **[X hours]** after the flight reached the gate, which is past the DOT cutoff of **[12 hours domestic / 15 hours / 30 hours international]**. Under 14 CFR Part 260 I'm owed a refund of my **checked-bag fee** to my original form of payment. Please process that."

For a paid service not provided (Wi-Fi, seat, boarding)

"I paid **[\$ amount]** for **[service]** and the airline didn't provide it — **[one sentence: 'the Wi-Fi never worked' / 'I was moved out of my paid seat']**. Under 14 CFR Part 260, fees for ancillary services that aren't provided must be refunded to the original form of payment. Please refund **[\$ amount]** to my **[card]**."

For denied boarding / being bumped

"I was **involuntarily denied boarding** on an oversold flight — flight **[number]**, **[date]**. Under **14 CFR Part 250** I'm entitled to **denied-boarding compensation** in cash, separate from any refund. Based on how late I'll reach my destination, that's **[\$1,075 or \$2,150]**. I'd like that paid by **check or original form of payment today**, and I'm declining any offer to substitute a travel voucher for the cash I'm owed."

(See Asset 07 for the full denied-boarding rules and the written claim.)

Closing every call/chat (do not skip)

"Before we finish: can you confirm the **refund amount**, the **form of payment** it's going back to, and a **reference or case number**? And can you send me a **written confirmation by email**? I have your name as **[AGENT NAME]** and the time as **[TIME]** — thank you."

Then: save the chat transcript or write down the reference number, and log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09).

If the call goes nowhere

Politely end it, note what was said and refused, and escalate with the **DOT complaint** (Asset 06). The written record of "I asked, they refused, here's the agent and time" makes the DOT complaint much stronger.

06 — US DOT Complaint Submission Template

When/how to use this

Use this when the airline **stalled, refused, missed the refund deadline, or gave you a voucher you didn't accept**. The U.S. DOT Office of Aviation Consumer Protection takes complaints directly, forwards them to the airline, and **requires the airline to respond**. It's **free**, and airlines take DOT complaints seriously because the DOT tracks and can fine them.

Where to file (free, official): - Online: <https://www.transportation.gov/airconsumer/file-consumer-complaint> (the live DOT complaint portal) - The portal has form fields; the template below is what you paste/adapt into the **"describe your complaint"** narrative box.

Before you file: you should have already contacted the airline once. The DOT process works best as an *escalation*, and the narrative is stronger when you can say "I asked the airline and they refused/ignored me."

What law backs it

The DOT enforces **14 CFR Part 260** (automatic refunds), **14 CFR Part 250** (denied-boarding compensation), and the broader prohibition on **unfair and deceptive practices (49 U.S.C. § 41712)**. You don't have to cite chapter and verse — naming Part 260 / Part 250 and stating plainly what the airline failed to do is enough.

COMPLAINT NARRATIVE (paste into the DOT "description" box)

Complaint type: [Refund — flight cancellation/significant change / Refund — ancillary fee / Refund — checked-bag fee / Denied boarding compensation]

Airline: [AIRLINE NAME] **Confirmation / record locator:** [CODE] **Ticket number:** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER] **Flight:** [FLIGHT NUMBER], [ORIGIN] → [DESTINATION], [DATE]

What happened (facts, in order): On [DATE], [AIRLINE NAME] [canceled / significantly changed by X hours / failed to provide the paid service of ____ / delivered my checked bag X hours late / denied me boarding on an oversold flight]. [One or two plain sentences of detail.]

I did not accept rebooking, a voucher, or a travel credit. I requested a refund to my original form of payment, **[\$ AMOUNT]** paid by **[ORIGINAL FORM OF PAYMENT]**.

What I did to resolve it: On [DATE] I contacted [AIRLINE NAME] via [phone / chat / their refund form] and requested the refund under 14 CFR Part 260. [The airline refused / offered only a voucher / did not respond / has now exceeded the required refund timeframe of 7 business days for credit-card payment / 20 calendar days for other payment.] [If you have it: I spoke with agent "[NAME]" at [TIME] on [DATE], case reference [NUMBER].]

The rule the airline did not follow: Under the DOT Automatic Refund Rule (**14 CFR Part 260**), the airline is required to issue an automatic refund to my original form of payment — not a voucher — within 7 business days (credit card) or 20 calendar days (other payment). [For denied boarding, cite **14 CFR Part 250** and the \$1,075 / \$2,150 compensation amounts instead.] That has not happened.

What I am asking for: A full refund of [**\$ AMOUNT**] to my original form of payment [**card / method**], [plus denied-boarding compensation of \$[1,075 / 2,150] if applicable], and written confirmation.

Attachments uploaded: [booking/receipt], [the cancellation or schedule-change notice], [my refund request to the airline + their response or proof of non-response], [bag report / Wi-Fi failure / seat documentation as applicable].

Contact info the DOT form will ask for

- Full name, mailing address, email, phone.
- Whether you've contacted the airline (answer **yes** and attach proof).
- The airline name and flight details above.

After you file

- The DOT sends your complaint to the airline and gives it a tracking number. **Save it** and log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09), status = "DOT filed."
- The airline must respond to you and to the DOT. Most refund cases that were being ignored get resolved at this stage.
- Keep all correspondence. If the airline still refuses despite a clear Part 260/250 obligation, the DOT complaint is on record and contributes to enforcement.

07 — Denied-Boarding / Bumping Compensation Claim Letter

When/how to use this

Use this when you were **involuntarily denied boarding** ("bumped") from an **oversold** flight — meaning the airline sold more seats than it had and you didn't get on, against your will. This is one of the few situations where U.S. law owes you a **fixed cash payment**, on top of (not instead of) refunding or rebooking you.

Key points: - This is for **involuntary** bumping. If you **volunteered** to give up your seat for a deal you negotiated, that's a separate voluntary arrangement and these fixed amounts don't apply. - The airline must give you a **written statement** of your denied-boarding rights at the gate. If they didn't, note that. - The compensation is based on **how late the airline gets you to your final destination** versus your original arrival.

How much you're owed (effective January 22, 2025):

How late you arrive at your destination	Compensation
Domestic: rerouted to arrive 1–2 hours late · International: 1–4 hours late	200% of your one-way fare, up to \$1,075
Domestic: arrive more than 2 hours late · International: more than 4 hours late	400% of your one-way fare, up to \$2,150
Airline gets you there with 0–1 hour delay	No mandatory cash compensation

You **also** keep your right to a refund or to be rebooked — the bumping payment is separate. And the airline generally must pay you **on the day and at the place** the bumping occurred (by check or original payment).

What law backs it

14 CFR Part 250 (Oversales), § 250.5. Involuntary denied-boarding compensation caps are **\$1,075** (shorter delay) and **\$2,150** (longer delay), effective **January 22, 2025** (inflation-adjusted from the prior \$775 / \$1,550). The payment is in **cash or check**, not a voucher, unless you voluntarily accept a substitute.

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Customer Relations **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE OFFICIAL FORM URL] and [EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name: [YOUR FULL NAME] **Confirmation / record locator:** [CODE] **Ticket number:** [13-DIGIT TICKET NUMBER]

Bumping details: - Flight I was denied boarding on: [FLIGHT NUMBER], [ORIGIN] → [DESTINATION], [DATE] (this was a ☐ domestic / ☐ international] flight) - I had a **confirmed**

reservation and met the check-in / boarding deadline: [YES — time I checked in: ____] - Denial was **involuntary** (I did not volunteer): YES - Original scheduled arrival at my final destination: [DATE/TIME] - Actual / rebooked arrival at my final destination: [DATE/TIME] → I arrived [**X hours**] late - One-way fare for this segment: [**\$ AMOUNT**]

To whom it may concern,

On the flight above, I held a confirmed reservation, met all check-in and boarding deadlines, and was **involuntarily denied boarding** because the flight was oversold. Under **14 CFR Part 250**, I am entitled to **denied-boarding compensation**.

The airline rerouted me to arrive [**X hours**] later than my original scheduled arrival at my final destination. Based on that delay:

[CHOOSE ONE:] - This was a [**domestic flight, arriving 1–2 hours late**] / [**international flight, arriving 1–4 hours late**], so I am owed **200% of my one-way fare, capped at \$1,075**. Two hundred percent of my one-way fare of [\$ AMOUNT] is [**\$ 2× FARE**]; the amount due is the lesser of that and \$1,075 = [**\$ AMOUNT DUE**]. - This was a [**domestic flight, arriving more than 2 hours late**] / [**international flight, arriving more than 4 hours late**], so I am owed **400% of my one-way fare, capped at \$2,150**. Four hundred percent of my one-way fare of [\$ AMOUNT] is [**\$ 4× FARE**]; the amount due is the lesser of that and \$2,150 = [**\$ AMOUNT DUE**].

This compensation is **separate** from my ticket — I [kept my ticket and was rebooked / am separately requesting a refund of the unused portion under 14 CFR Part 260]. The denied-boarding compensation is owed in **cash or check**, and I am declining any offer to substitute a travel voucher for the amount I am owed.

[If applicable: I was not provided the written statement of denied-boarding rights required under 14 CFR Part 250 at the gate.]

Please issue payment of [**\$ AMOUNT DUE**] by check or to my original form of payment, and confirm in writing.

Sincerely,

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

Attachments: [boarding pass / confirmed reservation], [proof of check-in time], [the rebooking showing your actual arrival time], [any written denied-boarding notice the airline gave you].

After you send it

- If the airline tried to pay you with a **voucher at the gate**, you can still insist on cash/check — accepting a voucher should be voluntary, not a default.
- The amount is based on your **one-way fare** for the bumped segment and the **delay to your final destination**, capped at \$1,075 / \$2,150. Show your math in the letter (above) so there's nothing to argue about.
- Log it in the Claim Tracker (Asset 09). Refusal or silence → Asset 06 (DOT complaint, citing 14 CFR Part 250).

08 — EU261 Claim Letter (Transatlantic Flights)

When/how to use this

Use this when your flight was **delayed 3+ hours on arrival, canceled, or you were denied boarding**, AND the flight is covered by EU Regulation 261/2004. This is a separate, often larger, money lever than the U.S. DOT rules — and it can apply to the same flight.

Is your flight covered? EU261 applies to: - **Any flight departing an EU/EEA airport** — on any airline, including U.S. carriers. (e.g., Paris → New York on Delta: **covered**.) - **A flight arriving in the EU/EEA only if** operated by an **EU/"Community" carrier**. (e.g., New York → Paris on Air France: **covered**.)

Not covered: A flight from a non-EU airport on a non-EU airline, even if it lands in the EU. (e.g., New York → Paris on United or Delta: **NOT covered** by EU261 — use the DOT assets instead.)

Quick test for transatlantic: **Departing Europe? Always covered. Flying into Europe? Only if it's a European airline.**

Send to the **operating airline's** EU claims / customer-relations address. Many EU carriers have a dedicated EU261 / "passenger rights" online form — use it if available, and email a copy.

What law backs it

Regulation (EC) No 261/2004, as interpreted by the Court of Justice of the EU (the *Sturgeon* and *Nelson* rulings, which extended cash compensation to long delays of **3+ hours at the final destination**). These rules remain in force in 2026; reform has been discussed but **not** enacted. Compensation is fixed by distance:

Flight distance	Compensation
1,500 km or less	€250
1,500–3,500 km (and intra-EU over 1,500 km)	€400

Flight distance	Compensation
Over 3,500 km (typical transatlantic)	€600

The airline can avoid compensation only by proving "**extraordinary circumstances**" that couldn't have been avoided even with all reasonable measures (e.g., severe weather, air-traffic-control strikes, security risks). Ordinary technical faults, staffing, and routine operational problems do **not** qualify. Compensation is owed *on top of* your right to a refund or rerouting.

(If your flight departed from or was on a UK carrier into the UK, the equivalent law is "UK261" — same structure, amounts set in GBP by the UK Civil Aviation Authority. Use the same letter and replace the citation with "UK Regulation (the retained version of EC 261/2004)".)

LETTER

To: [AIRLINE NAME] — Passenger Rights / EU261 Claims **Submitted via:** [AIRLINE EU261 CLAIM FORM URL] and [CUSTOMER-RELATIONS EMAIL] **Date:** [DATE]

Passenger name(s): [YOUR FULL NAME(S), as on the ticket] **Booking reference / PNR:** [6-CHARACTER CODE] **Ticket number(s):** [13-DIGIT NUMBER(S)]

Flight details: - Route: [ORIGIN AIRPORT] → [DESTINATION AIRPORT] - Operating carrier: [AIRLINE NAME] (the airline that actually flew the plane) - Flight number: [FLIGHT NUMBER] - Scheduled date: [DATE] - What happened: [☐ delayed 3+ hrs on arrival / ☐ canceled / ☐ denied boarding] - Scheduled arrival time: [TIME] — Actual arrival time: [TIME] — **Delay: [X hours Y minutes]** - Great-circle distance of the flight: [APPROX KM — e.g., New York–Paris ≈ 5,840 km]

To the operating carrier,

I am claiming compensation under **Regulation (EC) No 261/2004** for the flight identified above.

This flight is within the scope of the Regulation because it [☐ departed from an airport located in the EU/EEA / ☐ arrived in the EU/EEA and was operated by an EU/Community carrier].

The flight was [delayed by [X hours] at the final destination / canceled / I was denied boarding]. Under Article 7 of the Regulation, and the Court of Justice of the EU's rulings in *Sturgeon* (C-402/07) and *Nelson* (C-581/10) establishing that delays of three hours or more at the final destination give rise to the same compensation as a cancellation, I am entitled to fixed compensation.

The flight distance is over 3,500 km, so the compensation due is **€600 per passenger** under Article 7(1)(c). [If your flight is a shorter band, replace with: "The flight distance is [X] km, so the compensation due is €[250/400] per passenger under Article 7(1)([a/b])."]

Number of passengers on this booking: [N] **Total compensation claimed: €[AMOUNT] (€[PER-PERSON] × [N] passengers).**

This compensation is separate from, and in addition to, any refund or rerouting I am entitled to. I am not aware of any extraordinary circumstances under Article 5(3) that would relieve you of this obligation. If you intend to rely on the extraordinary-circumstances defense, please provide, in writing, the specific cause of the disruption and the evidence that it could not have been avoided even if all reasonable measures had been taken.

Please pay the compensation due to the following: - Payment method: [BANK TRANSFER / ORIGINAL CARD / CHEQUE] - Details: [IBAN / ACCOUNT / ADDRESS as needed]

Please respond within 14 days. If I do not receive payment or a substantiated extraordinary-circumstances explanation, I will escalate to the relevant national enforcement body (NEB) for the country of departure and, if necessary, pursue the claim through the courts or an alternative dispute resolution (ADR) scheme.

Yours faithfully,

[YOUR FULL NAME] [YOUR EMAIL] [YOUR PHONE] [YOUR MAILING ADDRESS]

Attached: [boarding pass(es) / booking confirmation / proof of actual arrival time / any delay notification from the airline]

After you send it

- **The clock and the threshold are everything.** Compensation hinges on the **actual arrival delay at your final destination** (gate/door open), not the departure delay. Save proof of when you actually arrived.
- **Don't accept a voucher as "compensation."** EU261 compensation is a cash payment. A meal voucher or travel credit is not a substitute.
- **If they claim "extraordinary circumstances,"** make them prove it in writing and name the cause. Weather and ATC strikes can qualify; a late inbound aircraft or a routine technical fault usually does not.
- **If ignored or refused:** escalate to the **National Enforcement Body** in the departure country (each EU state has one), or use the airline's ADR scheme. You have years to claim in most EU states (the limitation period is set by national law, often 2–6 years).
- You can pursue **both** an EU261 claim *and* a U.S. DOT refund where both apply — they cover different things (compensation vs. refund of what you paid).

Bank & Card Fees

The "Magic Words" Quick Card

When/how to use this: Print this one page and keep it by the phone. It's the whole pack distilled into the lines that actually move a rep to "yes." If you only read one page, read this one.

What law backs it: Nothing — and that's the point. Fee reversals are a *courtesy*, not a right, so these are persuasion lines, not legal claims. (The one exception is opting out of debit/ATM overdraft coverage, which *is* a right — see file 09.)

The single most powerful line

"Would you be willing to reverse this as a one-time courtesy?"

Say it once. Then **stop talking** and let them work. Silence closes more reversals than arguing ever will.

The 4-beat structure (every call, every chat)

1. **Be warm + name the relationship.** *"Hi — I've banked with you for [X] years and I'm hoping you can help me with something small."*
 2. **State the fee plainly, no story.** *"I was charged a [\$ amount] [fee name] on [date]."*
 3. **Ask with the magic words.** *"Would you be willing to reverse it as a one-time courtesy?"*
 4. **Go quiet.** Let them say yes.
-

Phrases that help

- "I take responsibility for this — I'm just asking for a one-time courtesy."
- "I'd really like to keep my account here in good standing."
- "I've been a customer since [year]."
- "Is there anything you can do on your end today?"
- "I completely understand it's at your discretion — I'm just asking."

Phrases to avoid

- ❌ "This is illegal." (It isn't — and it ends the goodwill.)
 - ❌ "I'll close my account!" (Empty threats burn the rep's willingness. Only say it if it's true and you mean it.)
 - ❌ Long backstory. Reps reverse fees faster when the ask is short.
 - ❌ Anything you have to lie to say.
-

If they say YES

- "Thank you — I really appreciate it."
- **Get it in writing:** "Can you give me a reference number for this?"
- **Confirm timing:** "When will the credit post?"
- **Log it** (file 10): date, name, reference #, amount, post date.

If they say NO / "I can't"

1. **Ask once more, softly:** *"I understand. Is there a supervisor or a retention team who might be able to as a courtesy?"*
 2. **Try the other channel:** if phone said no, try chat tomorrow (or vice versa) — a different rep is a different answer.
 3. **Switch to prevention:** *"Understood. Can you tell me how to avoid this fee going forward?"* (e.g., opt out of overdraft — file 09; set up alerts; waive maintenance with direct deposit — file 04.)
 4. **Know when to stop.** If you've genuinely used your courtesy for the year, accept it gracefully. Burning the relationship costs more than the fee.
-

The mindset

You are not begging and you are not entitled. You're a customer making a reasonable, polite request that costs the bank almost nothing to grant. Calm + brief + one clear ask = your best odds.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Overdraft / NSF Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use after an **overdraft fee** (the bank paid a transaction that put you negative and charged you) or an **NSF / returned-item fee** (the bank declined it and still charged you) posts to your checking account. Best within a few days of the fee, while it's fresh and you're still in good standing. Have your statement open with the exact fee amount and date.

What law backs it: No law forces this reversal — it's a goodwill courtesy. There is **no federal cap on overdraft fees** (the 2024 CFPB \$5-cap rule was repealed by Congress in 2025, Pub. L. 119-10). If the fee came from a **debit-card or ATM** overdraft and you never opted in, that's different — that may be an improper charge under Reg E (12 CFR 1005.17); see file 09 and use the "I never opted in" branch below. To *prevent* future debit/ATM overdraft fees entirely, opt out (file 09).

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, my name is [YOUR NAME]. I've banked with [BANK] for [X] years. I noticed an overdraft fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on my account from [DATE], and I'm hoping you can help me."

[THE ASK]

"I take responsibility for the overdraft, and I've already [brought the balance positive / made the deposit]. Would you be willing to reverse the fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Then stop talking. Let them respond.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I really appreciate that. Can I get a reference number for the reversal, and when will the credit post to my account?" - Log it (file 10): date, rep name, reference #, amount, expected post date.

► If they say NO / "I'm not able to do that"

"I understand it's at your discretion. Is there a supervisor or a customer-loyalty team who might be able to make a one-time exception? I've been a customer since [YEAR] and I'd

like to keep my account in good standing."

→ **If still NO:**

"Okay, I appreciate you checking. Two quick things: can you note that I asked for a courtesy reversal, and can you tell me how to make sure this doesn't happen again — for example, opting out of overdraft coverage or setting up a low-balance alert?" - Then try **chat** tomorrow with a different rep, or call back another day. A fresh rep is a fresh decision.

► **If it was a DEBIT-CARD or ATM overdraft and you never opted in**

"Before we go further — this fee was on a [debit-card purchase / ATM withdrawal]. I don't believe I ever opted in to overdraft coverage for everyday debit and ATM transactions. Under Regulation E, my understanding is the bank can only charge those overdraft fees if I affirmatively opted in. Can you check whether I'm opted in, and if I'm not, refund this fee and confirm I'm opted out going forward?"

→ **If they confirm you weren't opted in:** this is a correction, not a courtesy — they should refund it. Get a reference number and confirm your opt-out status (file 09).

► **If they offer a partial reversal**

"I appreciate that. Could you do the full amount this once? If not, I'll take the partial and I appreciate the help."

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I've been a [BANK] customer for [X] years. I was charged a [\$ AMOUNT] overdraft fee on [DATE]. I've already brought my balance positive. Would you be willing to reverse the fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you so much. Could you send me a reference number and let me know when the credit will post? I'd like to save this chat transcript for my records.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor or loyalty team who can review a one-time exception? I've been with [BANK] since [YEAR] and would like to keep my account in good standing.

→ **If still NO:**

You: Understood, thank you for checking. Can you note that I requested a courtesy reversal on [DATE]? And can you tell me how to opt out of overdraft coverage so this can't happen again?

→ **Debit/ATM, never opted in:**

You: This fee was on a debit-card/ATM transaction. I don't believe I opted in to overdraft coverage for everyday debit and ATM transactions. Under Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17), overdraft fees on those require my affirmative opt-in. Can you verify my opt-in status, and if I'm not opted in, refund this fee?

After the call/chat

- Save the chat transcript or write down the reference number immediately.
- Add the result to your **Reversal Log** (file 10).
- If a promised credit hasn't posted in the stated time, call back with the reference number — that's not a new ask, it's a follow-up.
- Want to stop this for good? Opt out of debit/ATM overdraft coverage (file 09).

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Late-Payment Fee Waiver — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use right after a **late fee** posts on a credit card or loan — ideally before the next statement closes, and ideally when you've already paid (or are paying that minute). Strongest if you have a history of on-time payments. Have the card/loan open, the fee amount, and the payment date ready.

What law backs it: No law forces a waiver — it's a goodwill courtesy, and issuers grant it routinely for otherwise-good customers. Context: there is **no \$8 federal cap** on credit-card late fees — the 2024 CFPB rule was vacated in court on April 15, 2025 (N.D. Tex.). Late fees follow the older CARD Act "safe harbor" framework (roughly up to ~\$30 for a first late payment and ~\$41 for a repeat, inflation-adjusted) and whatever your cardholder agreement sets. Don't cite an \$8 cap; it isn't the law. One real lever you *do* have: if this is your **first** late payment in a long time, the CARD Act limits how high a *first-violation* fee can be — but your play here is courtesy, not statute.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I've had this card for [X] years and I've paid on time consistently. I had a late fee of [\$ AMOUNT] post on [DATE]."

[THE ASK]

"I've already made the payment in full. Given my history, would you be willing to waive the late fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Stop talking. Let them respond.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I appreciate it. Can I get a reference number, and will this also reverse any interest charged on the late amount? When will the credit post?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor who can consider a one-time exception based on my payment history? I've been a cardholder since [YEAR] and this is the first time in a long while I've been late."

→ **If still NO:**

"I appreciate you looking. Could you at least note my request and my on-time history on the account? And can you set up an autopay or due-date reminder so this doesn't recur?" - Try chat another day with a different rep.

► **If they waive the fee but NOT the interest**

"Thanks for the fee. Could you also reverse the [\$ AMOUNT] interest tied to the late payment, since I've now paid in full? If not, I understand."

► **If they say "you've already had a waiver this year"**

"Understood — I didn't realize. I'll keep it on-time going forward. Can you tell me my exact due date and set up autopay so this can't happen again?" - Be honest with yourself: if you've used your courtesy, accept it and set up autopay.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I'm a [X]-year cardholder, account ending [LAST 4], with a strong on-time history. A [\$ AMOUNT] late fee posted on [DATE] and I've already paid in full. Given my history, would you be willing to waive the late fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Could you also reverse any interest on the late balance, and send me a reference number plus the post date? I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor consider a one-time exception based on my payment history since [YEAR]?

→ **If still NO:**

You: Understood — thank you for checking. Please note my request on the account. Can you also help me set up autopay so I never miss a due date again?

After the call/chat

- Confirm both the **fee** and any **interest** were reversed.
- Set up **autopay for at least the minimum** — it's the single best prevention.
- Log the result (file 10), including whether you've now used your annual courtesy.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Monthly Maintenance Fee Waiver — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **monthly service / maintenance fee** posts on a checking or savings account. Your goal is two things at once: (1) reverse the fee that just hit, and (2) get the fee **permanently waived** going forward by meeting a waiver condition (direct deposit, minimum balance, or switching to a free account). Have your account and the fee amount/date ready.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy. The real leverage is that almost every bank already offers a **fee-waiver path** (e.g., a monthly direct deposit, a minimum balance, or a no-fee account tier) and a **genuinely free checking option** usually exists. You're asking them to apply what already exists. If you bank somewhere with no free option, this is also your cue to consider a no-fee online bank or credit union.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I noticed a monthly maintenance fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on my [checking/savings] account on [DATE]. I'd like to sort this out two ways if I can."

[THE ASK — REVERSAL]

"First, would you be willing to reverse this month's fee as a one-time courtesy?"

[THE ASK — PREVENTION]

"And second, what do I need to do to have this fee waived every month — a direct deposit, a minimum balance, or switching to an account with no monthly fee?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES to the reversal

"Thank you. Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Then move straight to prevention (below) so this is the last time.

► If they say NO to the reversal

"I understand. Is there a supervisor who could make a one-time exception? I've been a customer since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:** go to prevention anyway — getting the fee waived forever matters more than this one month.

► PREVENTION — pick the path they offer

- **Direct deposit:** "If I set up a direct deposit of [\$ AMOUNT], will that waive the fee every month? Can you set that requirement now?"
- **Minimum balance:** "What balance do I need to keep to avoid the fee? Can you note the exact threshold?"
- **Switch accounts:** "Do you have a checking account with no monthly maintenance fee that I qualify for? Can you switch me today, and will my account number and direct deposits carry over?"

► If they have NO free option and won't waive

"Understood. I appreciate your time. I may look at an account that better fits how I bank — can you confirm there's no early-closure fee and how to move my direct deposits if I do?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — a [\$ AMOUNT] monthly maintenance fee posted on my [checking/savings] on [DATE]. Two requests: (1) would you reverse this month's fee as a one-time courtesy, and (2) what do I need to do — direct deposit, minimum balance, or a no-fee account — to have it waived every month going forward?

→ **If YES to reversal:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please? And let's set up the waiver condition now so it doesn't recur.

→ **If NO to reversal:**

You: I understand. Could a supervisor review a one-time exception? Either way, please help me set up the monthly waiver so this is the last time.

→ **Prevention:**

You: Which is easiest to qualify for — the direct-deposit waiver, the minimum-balance waiver, or switching to a no-monthly-fee account? Please set up whichever I qualify for and confirm it's active.

After the call/chat

- Confirm the **waiver condition is active**, not just promised — ask them to read back the requirement and confirm it's on the account.
- If you switched accounts, verify the new account has **no monthly fee** and your direct deposits/auto-payments moved.
- Log it (file 10). Note the exact waiver requirement so you can keep meeting it.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Returned-Item Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **deposited item bounced** and your bank charged you a "returned deposited item" / "returned item" fee — for example, you deposited a check or accepted an ACH that was later returned unpaid, and the bank dinged *you* (the receiver) for it. This is distinct from an NSF fee on a payment *you* sent (use file 02 for that). Have the item, the return date, and the fee amount ready.

What law backs it: No law forces this reversal — it's a goodwill courtesy. The fair-minded angle that helps here: the item bounced because of the **payer**, not you, so you're asking the bank not to penalize you for someone else's bad check. Many banks will reverse a returned-deposited-item fee the first time, especially if you're chasing the payer to make it right. (Note: if the *amount* of the fee is wrong or it was charged in error, that's a dispute, not a courtesy — see the error branch.)

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I deposited a [check/ACH] on [DEPOSIT DATE] for [\$ ITEM AMOUNT], and it was returned unpaid. I see your returned-item fee of [\$ FEE AMOUNT] posted on [DATE]."

[THE ASK]

"The item bounced because of the person who paid me, not because of anything on my end — and I'm already working to collect from them. Would you be willing to reverse the returned-item fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Stop talking.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you. Can I get a reference number and the post date for the credit?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor who could make a one-time exception? I'm the one who got stiffed on the payment, so the fee feels like a double hit. I've banked here since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:**

"I appreciate you checking. Can you note my request, and tell me whether re-depositing the item would trigger another fee if it bounces again?" - Try chat another day with a different rep.

► **If the fee amount looks WRONG or you were charged twice**

"Before we treat this as a courtesy — I want to confirm this fee is even correct. I was charged [\$ FEE AMOUNT] on [DATE], but [I only deposited one item / I see two fees / this doesn't match my agreement]. Can you review whether this fee was applied in error? If it was, I'd like it corrected." - A genuine error is a correction, not a favor. Get a reference number.

► **If they reversed the bank's fee but you're still out the bounced money**

"Thanks for the fee reversal. Separately — what are my options to recover the [\$ ITEM AMOUNT] that bounced? Can I re-deposit, and is there anything you can flag on the payer's item?" - (Recovering the underlying money is between you and the payer; the bank can only handle its own fee.)

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I deposited a [check/ACH] for [\$ ITEM AMOUNT] on [DEPOSIT DATE] and it was returned unpaid. A returned-item fee of [\$ FEE AMOUNT] posted on [DATE]. The item bounced on the payer's end, not mine, and I'm chasing them for it. Would you be willing to reverse the returned-item fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please? I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor review a one-time exception, given that the item bounced through no fault of mine? I've banked here since [YEAR].

→ **Wrong amount / charged twice:**

You: Can you first confirm this fee is correct? I see [describe discrepancy], which doesn't match my account agreement. If it was applied in error, please correct it rather than treat it as a courtesy.

After the call/chat

- Confirm the credit and **log it** (file 10).
- If you re-deposit the item, ask whether a second bounce triggers another fee.
- Remember: the bank can reverse **its fee**; getting your bounced **money** back is a matter between you and whoever wrote the bad check.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

ATM Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when you were charged an **ATM fee** — either your own bank's out-of-network fee, the ATM operator's surcharge, or both — on a recent withdrawal. Best within a few days. Note that two separate fees can appear: one from **your bank** (out-of-network) and one from the **ATM owner** (surcharge). Your bank can reliably reverse its own fee; the surcharge it sometimes refunds as a courtesy or rebate.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy. Useful leverage: many accounts include a number of **free out-of-network ATM uses per month** or an **ATM-fee rebate** benefit you may not know you have, and some banks will refund a surcharge as a one-time courtesy. Ask what your account already includes. (If you see a surcharge you were never warned about at the machine, mention it — operators are generally required to disclose the surcharge before you complete the withdrawal.)

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I used an out-of-network ATM on [DATE] and I see [an out-of-network fee of \$ AMOUNT / a surcharge of \$ AMOUNT / both, totaling \$ AMOUNT]. I'm hoping you can help."

[THE ASK]

"Would you be willing to reverse the ATM fee as a one-time courtesy? And does my account include any free out-of-network ATM uses or ATM-fee rebates I should be using?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you. Does that cover both the out-of-network fee and the operator surcharge, or just one? Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand. Is there a supervisor who could do a one-time courtesy? I've been a customer since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:**

"Okay, I appreciate it. Can you tell me which ATMs are in-network and free for me, and whether my account has any out-of-network rebate I should switch on?"

► If they reverse THEIR fee but not the operator surcharge

"Thanks for reversing the out-of-network fee. The ATM operator also charged a [\$ AMOUNT] surcharge — is there any rebate or one-time courtesy you can apply to that as

well? If not, I understand."

► If your account HAS a rebate/free-ATM benefit you didn't use

"It sounds like my account includes [rebates / free uses] I wasn't getting credit for. Can you apply that retroactively to this withdrawal, and make sure it's active going forward?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I was charged an ATM fee on [DATE]: [\$ AMOUNT out-of-network / \$ AMOUNT surcharge / both]. Would you be willing to reverse it as a one-time courtesy? Also, does my account include any free out-of-network ATM uses or fee rebates?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Does that cover both the out-of-network fee and the operator surcharge? Reference number and post date, please.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor apply a one-time courtesy? I've been a customer since [YEAR]. Either way — which ATMs are free for me, and do I have any rebate I should turn on?

After the call/chat

- Note whether they reversed **one fee or both** (out-of-network + surcharge).
- **Prevention:** ask for your in-network ATM map, or confirm any fee-rebate benefit is switched on. Going forward, use in-network ATMs or take cash back at a store register to avoid the fee entirely.
- Log it (file 10).

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Foreign-Transaction Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **foreign-transaction fee** (typically 1%–3% of the purchase) posts on a credit or debit card — either from travel abroad or from an online purchase billed by a foreign merchant. Be realistic: FX fees are the **hardest** of all these to reverse, because they're a flat percentage the issuer/network actually incurs, not a penalty. Your stronger play is usually prevention (a no-FX-fee card). But a polite one-time ask still works often enough to be worth 5 minutes, especially for a first-time or surprise charge.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy, and a relatively grudging one. Honest framing: foreign-transaction fees are disclosed in your cardholder agreement and aren't penalties, so you're genuinely asking for a favor here. The realistic win is often a **one-time courtesy credit** plus a switch to a **no-foreign-transaction-fee card** so it never happens again.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I see a foreign-transaction fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on a purchase from [DATE]. I wasn't expecting it, and I'm hoping you can help."

[THE ASK]

"I understand foreign-transaction fees are part of the card. As a [X]-year customer, would you be willing to refund this one as a one-time courtesy? And does the bank offer a card with no foreign-transaction fee I could switch to?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I really appreciate that. Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Log it (file 10), then ask about the no-FX-fee card so it doesn't recur.

► If they say NO (most common)

"I completely understand — I know it's not a penalty fee. Is there any one-time courtesy credit you can apply given my history? And which of your cards has no foreign-transaction fee?"

→ **If still NO:**

"No problem, thanks for checking. I do a fair amount of [travel / international shopping], so a no-foreign-transaction-fee card would suit me better. Can you tell me which card that is and how to switch without opening a new account, if possible?"

► **If the charge looks WRONG (you didn't buy abroad, or it's a duplicate)**

"Actually, I want to confirm this is even a valid foreign-transaction fee. This purchase was [from a U.S. merchant / one I don't recognize / charged twice]. Can you review whether this was applied in error? If I don't recognize the underlying charge at all, I'd like to dispute the transaction." - A misapplied FX fee or an unrecognized charge is a **dispute**, not a courtesy. For an unauthorized charge, your card's dispute process (and, for debit, Reg E error resolution) applies — see file 09's note on disputes.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — a foreign-transaction fee of [\$ AMOUNT] posted on a purchase from [DATE], account ending [LAST 4]. I understand it's part of the card, but as a [X]-year customer, would you refund this one as a one-time courtesy? And do you offer a card with no foreign-transaction fee?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please. I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: Understood — I know it isn't a penalty. Any one-time courtesy credit given my history? And which of your cards has no foreign-transaction fee, so this doesn't recur?

→ Looks wrong / unrecognized:

You: Can you confirm this fee is valid? The purchase was [U.S. merchant / unrecognized / duplicated]. If the underlying charge isn't mine, I'd like to dispute it, not treat it as a courtesy.

After the call/chat

- If refunded, confirm the **reference number** and post date; log it (file 10).
- **Prevention is the real win:** for any regular international spending, get a **no-foreign-transaction-fee card**. The fee you avoid forever beats the one you claw back once.
- For debit abroad, check whether your bank refunds or waives FX fees on certain accounts before your next trip.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Credit-Card Annual Fee — Retention + Product-Change Call

When/how to use this: Use when your **annual fee** just posted (or is about to) and you want one of three outcomes, in order of preference: (1) **fee waived** or offset by a retention offer; (2) **product change / downgrade** to a no-annual-fee version of the same card (keeps your account age and credit line); or (3) a clear decision to keep, downgrade, or cancel. Call in the **statement cycle the fee posts** — most issuers will reverse a freshly posted annual fee if you act fast. Have the card, the fee amount, and your usage in mind.

What law backs it: No law forces a waiver or retention offer — these are pure business/goodwill decisions, and issuers make them constantly to keep customers. Useful, honest context: a **product change** (e.g., downgrading to the no-fee version of the same card) is usually treated as keeping the **same account**, so it typically does **not** start a new account or close the old one — better for your credit history than canceling. Confirm this with the rep for your specific card.

PHONE SCRIPT — ask for "retention" or "cancellations"

Tip: When the menu asks, say **"cancel"** or **"close my account."** That routes you to the retention/loyalty team — the people who can actually waive fees and make offers.

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. My [\$ AMOUNT] annual fee just posted on [DATE], and I'm deciding whether the card still makes sense for me. I've been a cardholder for [X] years."

[THE ASK]

"Before I make any changes, is there a retention offer available — a fee waiver, a statement credit, or bonus points that would offset the annual fee?"

→ **Let them check. Stay quiet while they look.**

► If they OFFER a waiver or retention offer

"That works — let's do that. Can you confirm the offer in writing or give me a reference number, and tell me exactly when the credit posts and any spending requirement?" - Log it (file 10): the offer, the reference #, any "spend \$X" condition and deadline.

► If they offer NOTHING (or a weak offer)

"I appreciate you checking. If there's no offer that offsets the fee, can you tell me whether there's a **no-annual-fee version of this card** I could switch to with a product change — keeping my same account, history, and credit line?"

► PRODUCT CHANGE / DOWNGRADE branch

"I'd like to do a product change to the no-annual-fee [CARD NAME] rather than cancel. Can you confirm: does this keep my same account number and account age, does it refund or remove the annual fee, and does it avoid a hard credit pull?"

→ **If they confirm:** great — that keeps your credit history intact and kills the fee. → **If a product change isn't available:** decide between paying the fee (if the rewards justify it) or canceling (below).

► CANCEL branch — only if you mean it and the math says so

"Understood. If there's no offer and no fee-free product change, I'd like to cancel before the fee becomes non-refundable. Can you confirm the annual fee will be refunded on closure, and that there's no balance or pending rewards I'd forfeit?" - Before canceling, weigh: closing a card can lower your average account age and total available credit, which can affect your credit score. Downgrading (product change) usually avoids that. Don't cancel just to make a point.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — my [\$ AMOUNT] annual fee posted on [DATE], account ending [LAST 4]. I'm a [X]-year cardholder deciding whether to keep the card. Before I change anything: is there a retention offer — a fee waiver, statement credit, or bonus points — that would offset the annual fee?

→ **If offer:**

You: That works. Please confirm the offer and any spending requirement in writing, with a reference number and the credit post date.

→ **If no offer:**

You: Understood. Is there a no-annual-fee version of this card I can switch to via a product change — keeping the same account, history, and credit line, with no hard pull? If so, I'd like to do that and have the annual fee removed.

→ **Product change confirm:**

You: To confirm: product change keeps my account number and age, removes/refunds the annual fee, and avoids a hard inquiry — correct? Please process it and send confirmation.

After the call/chat

- If you got a **retention offer**, write down any **spending requirement and deadline** — offers often require "spend \$X in Y months." Missing it means no credit. Log it (file 10).
- If you did a **product change**, confirm the new card has **no annual fee** and your account history carried over.
- Decision rule: **waiver > product change/downgrade > pay the fee (if rewards justify) > cancel**. Cancel last — it can ding your credit.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Regulation E Overdraft Opt-OUT Request — Phone + Chat + Written

When/how to use this: Use this when you want to **stop future overdraft fees on your everyday debit-card and ATM transactions** for good. This is the one asset in the pack that asserts an actual **right**, not a courtesy. By opting out (or confirming you never opted in), your bank must **decline** an ATM or one-time debit-card transaction that would overdraw your account instead of paying it and charging you a fee. Do this once and you remove a whole category of future fees.

Read the limit carefully — this is important: Opting out under Regulation E only stops overdraft fees on **ATM withdrawals and one-time (everyday) debit-card purchases**. It does **NOT** stop overdraft fees on: - **Checks** you write, - **ACH / automatic bill payments** (e.g., your electric bill, gym, subscriptions), - **Recurring debit-card payments** (e.g., a monthly streaming charge set up on your card).

Those are governed by your account agreement, not by this rule. So opting out is powerful but not total — pair it with low-balance alerts (covered at the end).

What law backs it: Regulation E, 12 CFR 1005.17. A bank may **not** charge you an overdraft fee on an ATM or one-time debit-card transaction **unless you affirmatively opted in** to that "overdraft service" after getting the required notice. You have the right to **opt out / revoke that consent at any time**, and the bank must honor it. There are **no required "magic words"** — you just have to make your choice clear and have it documented. (*Verified 2026: 12 CFR 1005.17 remains in force. Note the 2024 CFPB large-bank overdraft rule was nullified by Congress on May 9, 2025 (S.J. Res. 18 / Pub. L. 119-10) and is NOT law — but that has no effect on this opt-out right, which predates it and is unchanged.*)

Two things to ask for at once: (1) opt me OUT going forward, and (2) if I was charged ATM/one-time-debit overdraft fees while *not* opted in, refund them — that's a correction, not a courtesy.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I want to opt out of overdraft coverage for my ATM and everyday debit-card transactions, and confirm my current status."

[THE REQUEST]

"Under Regulation E, my bank can only charge overdraft fees on ATM and one-time debit-card transactions if I've opted in. I want to make sure I am opted **out** — meaning if a debit-card purchase or ATM withdrawal would overdraw my account, please decline it rather than pay it and charge me an overdraft fee. Can you set that and confirm it's active?"

→ **Let them process it.**

► Confirm it took

"Thank you. Can you confirm in writing — or give me a reference number — that I'm now opted out of overdraft coverage for ATM and one-time debit transactions, effective today? And to be clear: going forward those transactions will simply be declined if I don't have the funds, with no overdraft fee — correct?"

► If you were charged ATM/debit overdraft fees while NOT opted in (refund branch)

"I also want to check my history. I was charged overdraft fees on [DATE(S)] for [debit-card / ATM] transactions. Can you confirm whether I had actually opted in at those times? If I had not opted in, those fees shouldn't have been charged under Regulation E, and I'd like them refunded as a correction."

→ **If they confirm you weren't opted in:** this is not a favor — get each fee refunded and a reference number for each.

► If the rep is confused or pushes back

"To be specific, I'm referring to the Regulation E opt-in rule — 12 CFR 1005.17 — which says you can't charge overdraft fees on ATM or one-time debit transactions unless I opted in, and that I can revoke that consent at any time. I'm revoking it now. Can you process that or transfer me to someone who can?"

► Set expectations on the trade-off (so you're not surprised)

"I understand that with overdraft coverage off, an ATM withdrawal or debit purchase that exceeds my balance will be **declined** instead of going through with a fee. That's what I want. Can you confirm that's how it will behave?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — account ending [LAST 4]. I want to opt OUT of overdraft coverage for ATM and one-time debit-card transactions under Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17). Going forward, if a debit purchase or ATM withdrawal would overdraw my account, please decline it rather than charge an overdraft fee. Can you set that and confirm it's active today?

→ Confirm:

You: Thank you. Please confirm in writing that I'm opted out for ATM and one-time debit transactions, effective today, and that those will be declined (no overdraft fee) if I lack the funds. I'll save this transcript.

→ Refund branch (charged while not opted in):

You: I was also charged [debit-card/ATM] overdraft fees on [DATE(S)]. Can you confirm whether I had opted in at those times? If I had not, those fees weren't permitted under Reg E and I'd like them refunded as a correction, with a reference number for each.

→ If pushed back:

You: To be precise, this is the Regulation E opt-in rule, 12 CFR 1005.17. You can't charge overdraft fees on ATM/one-time debit transactions unless I opted in, and I can revoke

consent any time. I'm revoking it now. Please process it or route me to someone who can.

WRITTEN VERSION (secure message / mail — gives you a paper trail)

Subject: Opt-Out of Overdraft Service for ATM and One-Time Debit Transactions — [YOUR NAME], Acct ending [LAST 4]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to revoke my consent ("opt out") to overdraft service for ATM and one-time (everyday) debit-card transactions on the account ending in [LAST 4], pursuant to Regulation E, 12 CFR 1005.17.

Effective immediately, please do **not** authorize and pay ATM or one-time debit-card transactions that would overdraw my account. I understand and prefer that such transactions be **declined** rather than paid with an overdraft fee.

If your records show I was previously charged overdraft fees on ATM or one-time debit-card transactions during any period in which I had **not** affirmatively opted in, please treat those charges as improperly assessed under 12 CFR 1005.17 and refund them. Please confirm in writing that this opt-out is active, the effective date, and the disposition of any such refunds.

Thank you, [YOUR NAME] [DATE] [PHONE / EMAIL]

After you opt out — close the remaining gaps

Opting out kills ATM/debit overdraft fees, but **checks, ACH, and recurring debits can still overdraw and trigger fees**. To cover those:

1. **Turn on low-balance alerts** (text/email) so you know before a bill hits.
2. **Link a savings account or set up "overdraft protection transfer"** — a transfer from savings to cover a shortfall. Ask whether your bank charges a transfer fee (many no longer do); a small transfer fee is usually far cheaper than a \$35 overdraft fee, and some banks have eliminated it entirely.
3. **Confirm your opt-out is recorded** — ask the rep to read it back and log the reference number (file 10).

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free. This opt-out is your right under federal law; you never pay anyone to exercise it.

Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals

Asset 02 — Cancellation Scripts for Hard-to-Cancel Services

When/how to use this: Use these when a service won't let you cancel in account settings and forces you into a phone call, a chat, or an email — and then tries to stall, guilt, or "transfer" you. Pick the script for your channel (phone / chat / email). Read it nearly verbatim; the wording is chosen to close the loop and get proof.

What law backs it: You don't need to cite a law to cancel — these are firm, plain requests. But if the rep refuses or blocks you, the legal demand in **Asset 04** (ROSCA / state auto-renewal law) is the next step. For *retention/save offers* specifically, use **Asset 03**.

The 3 rules that make every cancellation stick

1. **Don't argue, don't explain.** You don't owe a reason. "It no longer fits my needs" ends the conversation; "well, money's tight and my kid started..." invites a save offer. Give no opening.
 2. **Use the word "cancel," not "pause," "downgrade," or "think about."** Reps are trained to convert soft language into a save.
 3. **Demand written confirmation before you hang up.** No confirmation = not canceled. (See Asset 06.)
-

SCRIPT A — Phone cancellation

Opening (say this immediately, before they pitch):

"Hi. I'm calling to cancel my [SERVICE] subscription on the account under [NAME / ACCOUNT EMAIL / ACCOUNT NUMBER], effective today. I've already made my decision, so I don't need to hear any offers. Please process the cancellation and give me a confirmation number."

If they ask why you're canceling:

"It no longer fits my needs. I'd like to proceed with the cancellation, please."

(Repeat that one sentence as many times as needed. Do not add detail.)

If they offer a discount or free months (hand off to Asset 03 if you're tempted; otherwise):

"I appreciate it, but I'm not looking for an offer. Please cancel the subscription effective today."

If they say "I can only pause it" or "I'll downgrade you":

"I'm not asking to pause or downgrade. I'm asking you to cancel the subscription entirely. If you're not able to do that, please transfer me to someone who can, or tell me the exact steps to cancel."

If they say it's already "scheduled to cancel at the end of the term" (and you want it stopped now / no further charges):

"Please confirm in writing that no further charges will be made to my card after today, and that the subscription will not auto-renew. What's the last date I'll have access, and what confirmation number can I reference?"

Closing (always get these three things):

"Before we finish, please confirm three things: one, the cancellation is processed effective [DATE]; two, no further charges will be made; three, you'll email written confirmation to [EMAIL] today. What's my confirmation number?"

Write in your tracker: date, time, rep's name, confirmation number.

SCRIPT B — Live chat cancellation

Paste this as your opening message:

"I'm requesting cancellation of my [SERVICE] subscription, account [EMAIL / ACCOUNT #], effective today. I've already decided and won't be accepting retention offers. Please confirm the cancellation and send written confirmation to my email. Please also confirm that no further charges will be made after today."

If the bot/agent loops you ("Are you sure? You'll lose..."):

"Yes, I'm sure. Please proceed with the cancellation now and provide a confirmation number."

If they say you must call to cancel:

"Per the terms I agreed to, I signed up [online/in this app]. Please cancel through this same channel, or escalate to someone who can. If a phone call is the only option, please provide the direct number and a reference number for this chat so I'm not restarting from scratch."

Always screenshot the chat or request the transcript by email. Chat transcripts are excellent dispute evidence.

SCRIPT C — Email / written cancellation

Use when there's a cancellation email address, or as a paper trail after a phone/chat cancellation. Send from the email on the account.

Subject: Cancellation request — [SERVICE] — account [ACCOUNT # / EMAIL]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am canceling my [SERVICE] subscription, effective immediately. My account details are:

- Name on account: [NAME]
- Account email / number: [EMAIL / ACCOUNT #]
- Billing descriptor I see on my statement: [DESCRIPTOR]

Please process this cancellation today and confirm in writing:

1. The cancellation is effective as of [DATE];
2. No further charges will be made to my payment method after that date;

3. The subscription will not auto-renew.

Please send written confirmation and a reference number to this email address. If any further action is required from me to complete the cancellation, tell me exactly what it is in your reply.

Thank you, [NAME] [DATE]

What to do if they simply won't cancel

If the company refuses, makes cancellation impossible, or hides the option for a subscription you signed up for online → escalate to **Asset 04** (the ROSCA / state-law demand letter). If they cancel "going forward" but charge you again anyway → **Asset 06** then **Asset 07** (card dispute).

Asset 03 — Retention / "Save Offer" Counter-Scripts

When/how to use this: The moment a rep or chatbot tries to keep you with a discount, free months, a downgrade, or a guilt trip. Find the tactic they used below and read the matching reply. Each one is built to either (a) get you out clean, or (b) extract a genuinely good deal if you'd actually stay for the right price.

What law backs it: None — this is negotiation, not a legal demand. (If they cross from "offering" into "refusing to let you cancel," switch to Asset 04.)

First, decide your real goal before you pick up the phone

- **Goal = OUT, no matter what.** Then every offer gets a polite "No, please cancel." Don't let a 50%-off number reactivate the part of your brain that signed up in the first place. You already decided this is dead weight in your audit.
- **Goal = stay only if it's genuinely cheaper.** Then you can let them bid. Set your number in advance ("I'll stay at \$X/month, otherwise cancel") and don't move off it.

Either way, the scripts below keep you in control.

Tactic 1 — "I can give you 50% off / three months free to stay."

If you want OUT:

"I appreciate that, but a discount doesn't change my decision. Please cancel the subscription effective today."

If you'd stay for the right price:

"I'll stay if you can lock that rate in for the next 12 billing cycles, in writing. If it's only a few months and then snaps back to full price, I'd rather cancel today. Can you do 12 months at that rate, yes or no?"

(If yes: get it in writing with an end date and the rate. If no: "Then please cancel today.")

Tactic 2 — "Let me just pause your account instead."

"No, I don't want a pause — a pause leaves the account open and I'll be right back here in a few months. Please cancel it entirely, effective today, with no auto-renewal."

Tactic 3 — "You'll lose all your data / history / progress."

"I understand, and I've accepted that. Please proceed with the cancellation. If there's a way to export my data first, tell me how and I'll do it now — but I still want the cancellation processed today."

Tactic 4 — "Let me downgrade you to the cheaper plan."

If you want OUT:

"I'm not looking to downgrade. I want to cancel completely. Please process that today."

If a cheaper plan actually works for you:

"What exactly does the cheaper plan include, what does it cost per cycle, and is that price permanent or promotional? Email me those terms. If it's permanent and covers [the one thing you use], I'll move to it; otherwise cancel."

Tactic 5 — "I'll need to transfer you to the retention department."

"That's fine. Before you transfer me, please note on the account that I've requested cancellation effective today, and give me a reference number for this call. I'd like the cancellation honored as of now even if the transfer drops."

(This protects your cancel date if the call "accidentally" disconnects during transfer — a known stall tactic.)

Tactic 6 — "We can only cancel at the end of your billing term" (you want no more charges)

"Please confirm in writing that today's request stops any auto-renewal and that no charge will be made on or after [NEXT RENEWAL DATE]. I'm fine using the service until the paid period ends, but I will not be charged again. Please send that confirmation and a reference number to [EMAIL]."

Tactic 7 — "Are you sure? Most people regret canceling."

(Guilt / FUD. Don't engage the emotion.)

"Yes, I'm sure. Please cancel the subscription now and send me written confirmation."

Tactic 8 — The chatbot loop ("Click here to keep your benefits...")

Don't click the "keep" path. Type:

"Cancel my subscription. Do not apply an offer. Confirm cancellation and email me confirmation."

If it keeps looping, ask for a human: **"Connect me to a live agent to process a cancellation."**

Tactic 9 — They go silent / "system is down, call back later."

"I understand the system may be down. Please log my cancellation request with today's date and time as the effective date, and email me a reference number now confirming the request was received. I should not be charged for any period after today."

(Get the request time-stamped today. That timestamp is your evidence if they bill you again — feed it into Asset 06 / 07.)

The universal closer (use after any save attempt)

"Thanks. To confirm: the subscription is canceled effective [DATE], there will be no further charges, and you're emailing written confirmation to [EMAIL] now. What's my confirmation number?"

No confirmation number + no email = treat it as NOT canceled. Keep going, or escalate to Asset 04.

Asset 04 — The Online Cancellation Demand (ROSCA + State Auto-Renewal Law)

When/how to use this: Use this when a company makes it genuinely hard or impossible to cancel a subscription you signed up for **online** — no cancel button in your account, forced phone-only cancellation with endless holds, a cancel flow that errors out, or a flat refusal. Send it in writing (email to their support/legal/privacy address, or via their contact form, from the email on your account). It raises the stakes from a routine request to a documented legal demand.

What law backs it (and what does NOT — read this):

- **DO NOT cite the FTC "click-to-cancel" rule.** A federal appeals court **vacated it on July 8, 2025** (*Custom Communications, Inc. v. FTC*, 8th Cir.) and it is **not in force in 2026**. If you cite it, an informed rep can dismiss your whole letter. The scripts in this kit deliberately rely on law that *is* still enforceable:
- **ROSCA — Restore Online Shoppers' Confidence Act, 15 U.S.C. §§ 8401–8405.** Still law. For anything sold via a **negative-option feature on the internet**, the seller must provide **simple mechanisms for a consumer to stop recurring charges** (15 U.S.C. § 8403). Blocking or burying cancellation conflicts with this.
- **Section 5 of the FTC Act, 15 U.S.C. § 45** — prohibits unfair or deceptive practices, which the FTC has applied to cancellation runarounds.
- **State auto-renewal laws.** Many states have them. **California's Automatic Renewal Law (Bus. & Prof. Code §§ 17600–17606)**, strengthened by AB 2863 **effective July 1, 2025**, now generally requires businesses to let consumers cancel **through the same medium they used to sign up** — i.e., an online "click-to-cancel" path for online sign-ups — and bars obstructing cancellation. Use the California paragraph only if you are a California consumer (or the company operates there); otherwise check your own state's auto-renewal law and substitute it, or rely on the federal ROSCA paragraph alone.

Use the bracketed California paragraph **only if it applies to you**. If you're not in a state with an auto-renewal cancellation law, delete that paragraph — the ROSCA and FTC Act grounds stand on their own for online subscriptions.

The Demand Letter

Subject: Formal cancellation demand and request for confirmation — [SERVICE], account [ACCOUNT # / EMAIL]

To [COMPANY] Customer Support / Legal Department,

I am writing to demand cancellation of my subscription to [SERVICE], and to document that your cancellation process has so far prevented me from doing so.

Account details - Name on account: [NAME] - Account email / number: [EMAIL / ACCOUNT #] - Billing descriptor on my statements: [DESCRIPTOR] - Approximate charge: [\$AMOUNT] per [CYCLE]

What happened I signed up for this subscription online on [DATE / approx]. I have attempted to cancel on [DATE(S)] by [describe: "using your account settings, where no cancellation option exists" / "calling [NUMBER] and being placed on hold for [TIME] /

transferred repeatedly" / "your cancel flow returned an error" / etc.]. I have been unable to complete a cancellation.

The law Because I purchased this subscription through an online negative-option feature, the **Restore Online Shoppers' Confidence Act (ROSCA), 15 U.S.C. § 8403**, requires you to provide simple mechanisms for a consumer to stop recurring charges. Obstructing or omitting an accessible cancellation method is also inconsistent with **Section 5 of the FTC Act, 15 U.S.C. § 45**, which prohibits unfair and deceptive practices.

[INCLUDE ONLY IF YOU ARE A CALIFORNIA CONSUMER: As a California consumer, I am also protected by California's Automatic Renewal Law, **Cal. Bus. & Prof. Code §§ 17600–17606**, which — as amended effective July 1, 2025 — requires that I be able to cancel through the same medium I used to enroll, and prohibits obstructing cancellation. Because I enrolled online, I am entitled to cancel online.]

What I am demanding 1. Cancel my subscription effective today, [DATE], and stop all auto-renewal. 2. Confirm in writing to this email that the cancellation is processed, the effective date, and that **no further charges will be made** to my payment method. 3. Provide a reference number for this request.

If I am charged again after the date of this letter, I will treat the charge as billing for a service I have canceled and will dispute it with my card issuer as a billing error under the **Fair Credit Billing Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1666**, and I reserve the right to report the practice to the Federal Trade Commission (reportfraud.ftc.gov) and to my state attorney general's consumer-protection office.

Please respond within 5 business days.

[NAME] [DATE] [PHONE / EMAIL]

After you send it

- **Save everything:** a copy of this letter, the send date, and any reply. This bundle is your evidence for a card dispute.
- **Cross off in your tracker:** set Status to "Cancel requested" with today's date.
- **If they comply:** great — get the confirmation, set Status to "Confirmed canceled," and you're done.
- **If they ignore you or charge you again:** go to **Asset 06** (confirmation demand) if you still lack written proof, then **Asset 07** (FCBA card dispute). You have a clean paper trail now, which is exactly what wins a dispute.

- **Optional escalation that gets fast results:** file a short complaint at reportfraud.ftc.gov and with your **state attorney general**. Companies often resolve a stuck cancellation within days once a regulator complaint number is attached.

Asset 06 — The Cancellation-Confirmation Demand

When/how to use this: Use this the moment you've *asked* to cancel but don't yet have **written proof** the cancellation went through — for example, you canceled by phone and only got a verbal "you're all set," or you submitted an online cancel flow that didn't email you anything. A cancellation you can't prove is a cancellation you'll lose if they bill you again. This short demand forces the company to put it in writing, which is the exact evidence a card issuer wants if you later need to dispute (Asset 07). Send it from the email on your account.

What law backs it: No single statute requires a "confirmation email," so this is framed as a firm request, not a legal threat. But it sets up two real protections: if you signed up online, **ROSCA (15 U.S.C. § 8403)** requires a simple way to stop recurring charges; and if they charge you after this, you have a dated paper trail to dispute the charge as a billing error under the **Fair Credit Billing Act (15 U.S.C. § 1666)** for credit cards, or under the **Electronic Fund Transfer Act / Regulation E (15 U.S.C. § 1693 et seq.)** for debit cards.

Why this tiny step matters more than it looks

Most "they charged me after I canceled" disputes are lost for one reason: **the customer can't prove the cancellation date**. The company says "we have no record of a cancellation," and without written proof, it's your word against theirs. This one-paragraph demand fixes that. It takes two minutes and converts a vague verbal cancellation into dated, written evidence.

The Confirmation Demand (email)

Subject: Please confirm in writing — cancellation of [SERVICE], account [ACCOUNT # / EMAIL]

To [COMPANY] Customer Support,

On [DATE], I requested cancellation of my [SERVICE] subscription [by phone with a representative / through your online account settings / via live chat — pick one]. [If you have one: My reference/confirmation number for that request is [REF #].]

I have not yet received written confirmation, so I am requesting it now. Please reply to this email confirming the following:

1. My subscription is canceled, effective [DATE OF YOUR ORIGINAL REQUEST];
2. The subscription will not auto-renew;
3. No further charges will be made to my payment method on or after that date;
4. The date my access ends (if applicable).

Account details for your reference: - Name on account: [NAME] - Account email / number: [EMAIL / ACCOUNT #] - Billing descriptor on my statement: [DESCRIPTOR]

If your records do not show my cancellation, please treat this email as a renewed cancellation request effective today and confirm it the same way. Please reply within 5 business days.

Thank you, [NAME] [DATE]

After you send it

- **File the email and any reply** in the same place you keep your tracker. The reply (or the absence of one, with your sent-date stamp) is your evidence.
- **Update your tracker:** set Status to "Confirmed canceled" once you have the written confirmation. Paste the confirmation number / email date into the "Confirmation # or Email" column.
- **If they confirm but then charge you anyway, or if they ignore this and a charge posts** → go straight to **Asset 07** (the card-dispute letter). You now have exactly the dated paper trail that wins those disputes.
- **If you signed up online and they're stonewalling cancellation entirely**, escalate with the legal demand in **Asset 04** (ROSCA / state auto-renewal law) before disputing.

Asset 07 — The Chargeback / Billing-Dispute Letter (FCBA & EFTA)

When/how to use this: Use this when a company **charged you after you canceled, kept billing a subscription you ended, or refused to honor a cancellation** — and you've already tried to resolve it directly (Assets 04/06). This is a written dispute you send to **your card issuer or bank, not the merchant**. It invokes your statutory billing-error rights. Send it in writing even if you also dispute online or by phone — the written notice is what triggers the strongest legal protections and deadlines.

What law backs it — and pick the RIGHT one for your card:

- **Credit card** → **Fair Credit Billing Act (FCBA), 15 U.S.C. § 1666**. You may dispute a "billing error," which includes a charge for **goods or services not accepted or not delivered as agreed** — exactly the situation when you're billed for a subscription you canceled. **You must send written notice within 60 days** after the issuer transmitted the first statement showing the error. The issuer must **acknowledge within 30 days** and **resolve within two billing cycles (no more than 90 days)**. (Source: 15 U.S.C. § 1666(a)–(b).) Separately, your liability for genuinely **unauthorized** credit-card use is capped at **\$50** under 15 U.S.C. § 1643.
- **Debit card / bank account** → **Electronic Fund Transfer Act (EFTA), 15 U.S.C. § 1693 et seq., and Regulation E (12 C.F.R. part 1005)**. The FCBA does **not** cover debit cards. Report the error to your bank, generally **within 60 days** of the statement showing it. The bank typically has **10 business days** to investigate (extendable to 45 if it gives provisional credit). (Source: EFTA § 1693f; Reg. E § 1005.11.)

The 60-day clock is real — don't sit on it. Count 60 days from the date of the statement that first showed the wrongful charge. Send your written dispute well inside that window.

Before you send: have your evidence ready

Attach copies (never originals) of:

- The statement line showing the disputed charge (highlight it).
- Your cancellation confirmation, or the cancellation request you sent (Asset 04 / 06) with its date.
- Any company reply, including a refusal to cancel or refund.
- Your tracker row for this service.

A dispute backed by a dated cancellation request wins far more often than a bare "I didn't authorize this."

LETTER A — Credit card (FCBA billing-error dispute)

Send to the **"billing inquiries" address** on your statement or issuer's website — **not** the payment address. Send it so you have proof of delivery (certified mail, or the issuer's secure-message system with a saved copy).

[YOUR NAME] [YOUR ADDRESS] [DATE]

[CARD ISSUER NAME] Billing Inquiries [ISSUER BILLING-INQUIRIES ADDRESS]

Re: Billing-error dispute under the Fair Credit Billing Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1666 Account number: [CARD ACCOUNT # — last 4 or full as issuer requires]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to dispute a billing error on my account under the Fair Credit Billing Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1666. The disputed charge is:

- Merchant / billing descriptor: [DESCRIPTOR]
- Amount: [\$AMOUNT]
- Date of charge: [DATE]
- Statement date it appeared: [STATEMENT DATE]

This charge is a billing error because it is for goods or services that were not accepted or not delivered as agreed. I canceled this subscription on [CANCELLATION DATE] [by phone / online / in writing], and [I received written confirmation of the cancellation, a copy of which is enclosed / I have enclosed my dated cancellation request]. The merchant billed me for a subscription I had already canceled, so I did not accept or agree to this charge.

[If applicable: I contacted the merchant on [DATE(S)] to resolve this and request a refund. The merchant [refused / did not respond / acknowledged the cancellation but charged me anyway]. Copies of that correspondence are enclosed.]

Under 15 U.S.C. § 1666, please: 1. Acknowledge receipt of this dispute within 30 days; 2. Investigate and either correct the error or explain your findings within two complete billing cycles (and no later than 90 days); 3. Remove the disputed amount, and any related finance charges or fees, from my balance while the dispute is pending; 4. Report the disputed amount as "in dispute" to any credit bureau if you report on this account during the investigation.

Please send written confirmation of the resolution to the address above.

Sincerely, [YOUR NAME] [Enclosures: statement excerpt; cancellation confirmation / request; merchant correspondence]

LETTER B — Debit card / bank account (EFTA / Regulation E error notice)

Use this version when the charge hit a **debit card or bank account**. Send to your bank's error-resolution / dispute address.

[YOUR NAME] [YOUR ADDRESS] [DATE]

[BANK NAME] Electronic Fund Transfer Error Resolution [BANK DISPUTE ADDRESS]

Re: Notice of error under the Electronic Fund Transfer Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1693f, and Regulation E Account number: [BANK / DEBIT ACCOUNT #]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am notifying you of an error involving an electronic fund transfer from my account, under the Electronic Fund Transfer Act and Regulation E (12 C.F.R. § 1005.11). The transaction in question is:

- Merchant / descriptor: [DESCRIPTOR]
- Amount: [\$AMOUNT]
- Date posted: [DATE]
- Statement date it appeared: [STATEMENT DATE]

This transfer is in error. I canceled the subscription with this merchant on [CANCELLATION DATE], and the merchant nevertheless charged my account afterward. I did not authorize a charge for a subscription I had already canceled. [Enclosed are my cancellation confirmation/request dated [DATE] and any merchant correspondence.]

Please investigate this error as required by Regulation E. I understand you generally have 10 business days to investigate (and may provide provisional credit and extend the investigation to 45 days). Please reverse the disputed transfer and notify me of the results in writing at the address above.

Sincerely, [YOUR NAME] [Enclosures: statement excerpt; cancellation confirmation / request; merchant correspondence]

What to expect after you send it

- **Credit card (FCBA):** The issuer must acknowledge within **30 days** and resolve within **two billing cycles / 90 days**. While the dispute is pending, you don't have to pay the disputed amount, and they can't report it as delinquent for that reason. Most subscription disputes with a dated cancellation attached are resolved in your favor.
- **Debit card (EFTA):** The bank usually decides within **10 business days**, or gives you **provisional credit** and takes up to **45 days**. Provisional credit means the money is back in your account while they investigate.

- **If the dispute is denied:** ask for the denial in writing and the evidence they relied on. You can re-dispute with the cancellation proof, file a complaint with the **CFPB at consumerfinance.gov/complaint** (free, and banks respond fast to it), and report the merchant to the **FTC at reportfraud.ftc.gov** and your **state attorney general**.
-

One honest caveat

A chargeback is a powerful, legitimate tool — use it when a charge is genuinely wrong. It is **not** a way to get free months of a service you actually used and simply forgot to cancel. Dispute the charges that posted **after** your cancellation date, not the legitimate ones before it. Keeping your dispute clean and accurate is what keeps it winnable — and keeps your account in good standing.

© 2026 Money You're Owed. Educational content and document templates only — not financial or legal advice. Laws and figures change; always confirm current official guidance for your situation. Fill in the bracketed [PLACEHOLDERS] with your own details before sending any letter.